

Special 20th Anniversary Edition

1987 - 2007

Vistoso Tipster

It's More Than Living...It's a Lifestyle!

Sun City Vistoso Community Association, Inc.



March 2008

I want to offer my warm congratulations to Sun City Vistoso for 20 years of service to Arizona's seniors! During my visit to Sun City Vistoso in October 2003, I saw a community brimming with the kind of life, strength and independence that people look to enjoy all throughout life.

By the year 2020, more than a quarter of our state's population will be over the age of 60. And while retirement once meant sitting quietly, now it often means an active and healthy lifestyle – the kind of lifestyle that communities like Sun City Vistoso are making

possible. By facilitating its residents' involvement in many civic and community activities, Sun City Vistoso has helped to build not only the health of its residents, but the health of Arizona communities, as well.

Congratulations again on achieving this milestone – and here's to another 20 great years!

Yours very truly,

Janet Napolitano
Governor

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Visit our website
suncity-vistoso.com
for information about
our community.





Courtesy of Betty White

This is the original Del Webb sales office located at what is now Desert Butte.
It was torn down to make way for new homes.

Twenty-Year Success Story

by Jane McKinney

Twenty years ago it was just one big chunk of lush desert with a spectacular view of the Catalina Mountains. Today, it's a beautiful, well-planned retirement community, home to some 4,300 people.

At first, prospective residents had to come by shuttle from Del Webb's temporary office at Ina and Oracle to stare in amazement at the desert site, gasp at the mountains, look at floor plans and, perhaps, sign on the dotted line. Fearing that the name "Vistoso" in the sales literature might be confusing, Del Webb temporarily changed the name to Sun City Tucson. After Sun City Vistoso's official grand opening in January 1987, visitors could go directly to the site and tour model homes built there.

The first Trailblazers moved into their homes on Chalk Creek in July 1987. Less than 10 years later, Del Webb built house number 2,488 and subsequently turned the community over to the homeowners.

An elected seven-member Board of Directors makes basic decisions for the Sun City Vistoso Community Association, Inc. These decisions are carried out by a competent, paid staff. Resident volunteers serve on various important committees. The combined efforts result in a well-managed, fiscally-sound community.

Residents can enjoy almost every conceivable activity in spacious and beautiful facilities. Listed in the monthly newsletter, Vistoso Tipster, are numerous special events, workshops and classes, in addition to over 100 different clubs and groups.

And just as important, residents can pause, listen to the birds singing, marvel at the desert beauty surrounding them and glory in the changing colors of the majestic mountains. It's a pause to soothe the soul.

Sun City Vistoso

Community Association, Inc.

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Office of the Mayor
Oro Valley, Arizona
Proclamation

WHEREAS, the community of Sun City Vistoso was established in July of 1987; and

WHEREAS, Sun City Vistoso was annexed into the Town of Oro Valley in July 1987 and since that time, has always been an integral part of Oro Valley; and

WHEREAS, Sun City Vistoso Association includes 2,488 homes representing individuals from all over the United States; and

WHEREAS, Sun City Vistoso and the Town of Oro Valley have shared a long standing and successful relationship; and

WHEREAS, Sun City Vistoso residents have supported our Town in a number of ways by volunteering for Citizen's Volunteer Assistance Program, the Sun City Passa, Sun City government affairs and providing community service where needed; and

WHEREAS, the community of Sun City Vistoso attracts the kind of residents who care about their quality of life and have actively participated in all aspects of our community; and

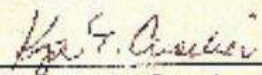
WHEREAS, the residents of Sun City Vistoso have always had a voice in helping to build our "Community of Excellence"

NOW, THEREFORE, I, Paul H. Loomis, Mayor of the Town of Oro Valley, Arizona, do hereby congratulate Sun City Vistoso on their 20 year anniversary and look forward to a continued harmonious relationship.

Dated this 12th day of December, 2007.


Paul H. Loomis, Mayor

ATTEST:


Kathryn Cuvier, Town Clerk



ASSOCIATION REFLECTIONS

From The Board of Directors



by Jane Arndorfer, President

As we reflect on the meaning of the 20th Anniversary of our community, several things to be grateful for come to mind. Paramount is the lovely physical setting in which we live, the always stunning mountains, the glorious multicolored sky, the benevolent climate and the abundance of desert flora and wildlife.

We who came later owe the Trailblazers much appreciation for having had the vision and courage to leave all that was familiar and dear to them in exchange for bare land, without roads, buildings or easy access to all the accustomed conveniences. The early resident/volunteers, who worked to simplify the governing documents adopted by the developers and insisted the Asset Reserve Fund be established to provide for the orderly replacement of comforts and necessities, deserve our admiration and respect. From the beginning, we've been blessed with loyal and talented staff who protect our interests and meet our needs.

Our many clubs, groups and committees each function within their own sphere of concern or responsibility to enrich our lives and add new dimensions. Here it's possible to start playing tennis at age 71 in a supportive environment, or try one's hand at photography for which you never before had time, or tackle the great books you feared were beyond your educational capacity.

Finally, hail to all the Boards of Directors who preceded us! Because of their efforts, we all enjoy a community highly regarded and well-maintained, financially stable and attractive to newcomers. This Board, like all others, recognizes its obligation to make decisions in the best interest of the entire community regardless of individual personal preferences.

Here's to the next twenty!

First Board President, Jim Stoetzel



I was on the Board of Directors in 1995, at the time of transition from Del Webb control to total resident control. At that time we had one board meeting per month! The committees continue to function now as they did then. On July 1, 1995, our carryover monies were \$0. During my first year the BOD established the Asset Reserve Fund, turned down a resident proposal to add nine holes of golf, built the Catalina Vista Recreation Center, approved the BODs being enlarged from five to seven members and started the monthly study sessions. I think times were easier then, there was excess income from golf, building maintenance was minimal and local politics were less involved.

In the late 1980s, the present Vistoso Center and the original Vacation Villas were sold to an outside investor. This created problems for the community when Del Webb's lease ran out. It meant, in 2000, the BOD bought back the present Vistoso Center instead of it being included as an asset at the time of transition.

However, we all agree we are fortunate to live in this marvelous community with so many amenities, neighbors who care and outside services just around the corner.

From the General Manager

Scott G. Devereaux, CMCA®, AMS



Twenty years. Doesn't it seem to go by in the blink of an eye? Del Webb created Sun City Vistoso as a unique community, much smaller than his earlier communities but containing a variety of amenities. Early years were influenced by the Del Webb model and by the first resident pioneers who we refer to as Trailblazers.

Through the years, the community has matured and taken on more of the character of the residents. Yes, the basic Del Webb philosophy is still here; but now the community reflects the attitude and efforts of all the residents who have lived here.

All communities have a combination of homes, facilities, amenities, roads, etc. So what makes a community truly great? It's the people. Residents willing to step forward to serve on the Board, a committee, be a leader in a club or just be a good neighbor and friend. We hear two common themes from new residents moving into the community; the people seem so friendly and the community is so well maintained. Both are a reflection of and testament to our residents.

So where are we going? We continue to invest in the community's future through periodic renovations and improvements of community assets. We continue to spend monies wisely and maintain the strong financial base the community enjoys. Finally, we show Tucson and beyond why this is a fun place to live.

The future is in the hands of current residents and those who will follow. If we maintain many of the traditions of the past, our future will be bright.

Our Developer, Del Webb

Del Webb was born in 1899 in Fresno, CA. He learned carpentry and had a passion for baseball at a very early age. Before completing high school, his privileged life changed as his father's company ran into financial problems and he was forced to quit school and become a carpenter's apprentice. Baseball, however, was still the driving force in his life and he supplemented his income as a semi-pro ballplayer.

At the age of 28 he contracted typhoid fever, an event that changed the course of his life. He and his wife moved to Phoenix, AZ, for his recuperation, giving up the idea of professional baseball and pouring his talents into carpentry. The rest is history!

A year later, in 1928, he started his own company. By the late 1930s his contracting business was one of the largest in AZ and he was offered numerous defense contracts. Several called for building entire cities, foreshadowing the development work that would make Del Webb famous. These projects introduced him to some very influential people, e.g., Howard Hughes, Bing Crosby, Bob Hope, and Barry and Robert Goldwater. In 1945 he was able to put his money where his heart was and, with a partner, purchased the New York Yankees.

In January 1960, an age-restricted community designed exclusively for active adults was opened and Sun City was born. Today there are over 30 such communities under the Del Webb umbrella and more are planned.

Del Webb also built factories, hotels, motor-hotels, hospitals, World's Fair exhibits, baseball stadiums and the famous Madison Square Garden in New York City.

Del Webb died on July 4, 1974. He will long be remembered for his most famous projects—the Sun Cities.

MEMORIES AND GREETINGS

I extend my congratulations to Sun City Vistoso as your community celebrates your twentieth anniversary. Sun City Vistoso offers a community experience in the true sense of the word with residents who are committed to preserving a dynamic lifestyle in a pristine setting. From support groups to athletic clubs, residents stay engaged in their neighborhood and invested in its improvement. Such conscious and vigilant management over the years has made Sun City Vistoso a good neighbor in Pima County.

Congratulations on a successful twenty years.

Ann Day, Pima County Board of Supervisors, District 1

It is my pleasure to offer a heartfelt "Congratulations!" on the celebration of your 20th anniversary as one of Oro Valley's most prominent communities. It has indeed been a pleasure working with the residents and your community leaders on issues that matter most to you.

Sun City Vistoso attracts the kind of residents who really care about their quality of life. You are always very active in all aspects of the community, and your voice has helped to build the community of excellence that we call home.

Best wishes on your anniversary celebration. We look forward to working with all of you as Oro Valley moves forward into the next 20 years--and beyond!

Oro Valley Mayor Paul Loomis

On behalf of all of us at Town Hall, I would like to congratulate the residents of Sun City Vistoso on their 20th anniversary.

Sun City Vistoso has always been an integral part of Oro Valley. The residents support our community in a number of ways: volunteerism, community service, activism. They are very involved and engaged. We have enjoyed working with the Association in every aspect of striving to build a strong community. Sun City Vistoso's residents have always been willing to work together with the town; this has been integral to our success.

We look forward to continuing to work together on behalf of this wonderful community of excellence. Congratulations, Sun City Vistoso, on achieving this terrific milestone!

Oro Valley Town Manager David Andrews

It caught us a bit by surprise that Sun City Vistoso is celebrating its twentieth anniversary. Last time I was in the area, I commented how nice the community looked and how many residents were walking around the community and participating in activities. The neighborhoods had matured nicely and were well maintained. Simply put, Sun City Vistoso didn't look its age. To us, that's a real testament to the Del Webb Sun City community concept, but more importantly, to the diligent efforts of all those resident participants, volunteers and staffers that keep the concept alive and fresh every day.

As Del Webb himself said, "Lumber, concrete and steel make the buildings but people make the community." Congratulations on your anniversary.

Richard J. Dugas, Jr., President and CEO
Pulte Homes (formerly Del Webb)

Congratulations on the 20th anniversary of your beautiful community and community association!

The Tucson Symphony Orchestra has enjoyed a long and happy relationship with music lovers there and we look forward to continuing it in the years to come. It is always a pleasure to perform for you, whether it is our Classics or TSO Pops! performances at the Tucson Music Hall or an ensemble program or even me speaking in Sun City Vistoso. Working in harmony with your staff and residents is always a delight.

May we all continue to enjoy the benefits of our picturesque corner of the world and our wonderful orchestra for many years to come!

George Hanson

Music Director and Conductor
Tucson Symphony Orchestra

ASSOCIATION COMMITTEES

Architectural Review

The ARC's (Architectural Review Committee) mission and primary role in our community is to maintain the aesthetic harmony of Sun City Vistoso, in keeping with the desert environment and the architectural character of the Sonoran Desert, while allowing the community to develop in an orderly, cohesive manner. The ARC implements this mission by meeting bimonthly to review and decide on applications from homeowners requesting exterior changes to their houses or lots.

The ARC is a standing committee, established in Sun City Vistoso's Declaration of CC&Rs (Covenants, Conditions and Restrictions). The specific standards and requirements for ARC review and approval of change requests are included in the CC&Rs and SCV Development Standards documents. The committee is made up of SCV homeowners, appointed by the Association Board of Directors. Daily administration of the change application process is handled by the Community Services Coordinator, a staff position.

Community Assistance Committee

The CAC (Community Assistance Committee) was established early in the life of Sun City Vistoso to provide medical appliances on a temporary basis to the community. Funds to purchase equipment were raised by holding pancake breakfasts and accepting donations. Later, cribs, cots, playpens and some toys were added to accommodate the needs of visiting children. As the operation grew, aluminum can collections, which have become a major activity, was added to assist in raising funds. All activities, staffing the Loan Room, recycling the aluminum cans, and serving the pancake breakfasts are handled by volunteers.

The mission of CAC is to identify the humanitarian needs of the community and provide suitable equipment to meet those needs. In addition to the Loan Room service, CAC annually contributes to the support of several community services activities. CAC also assists with Association projects for the beautification and improvement of community facilities.



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Consumer Referral

The Consumer Referral Committee was formed by the Board of Directors to provide a approved vendor source for such services as landscaping, plumbing and electrical repairs, etc., to the new community.

The committee, consisting of volunteers, manages the "Approved Vendor List" by continuously looking for new vendors to add to the existing list of over 100 vendors in 50 different categories. These vendors are licensed, bonded and insured where required and have been recommended by at least three residents. Many residents rely on this valuable service.

Finance and Budget

The Finance and Budget Committee provides an opportunity for interested residents to be involved in and contribute to the financial planning of our Community.

The primary work product of the Committee is a recommendation to the Association Board of Directors regarding the adoption of our annual budget. In practice, the committee works throughout the year with our management and the Board of Directors, usually the Treasurer, on a variety of financial issues. Our long history of "clean" reports from our independent auditors attests to the integrity of our financial management.

The Committee, functioning as the voice of the community, insures that the financial resources of Sun City Vistoso are adequate to maintain our status as a premier active adult community. We also monitor the efficient use of Association dues and work to keep them as low as is consistent with the long-term excellence of Sun City Vistoso.

Gift Shop

The Gift Shop of Sun City Vistoso supports the community by providing an outlet for the talent and creativity of our residents by displaying their personally produced arts and crafts for sale to the community and the public. We further support the community by contributing 17.5% of every sale to the general fund. The shop is managed by a committee of consignors who also serve as an advisory committee to the Board of Directors. The store is staffed by consignors and volunteers.

The Gift Shop is a convenient place to shop for unique handmade items and frequently saves a trip into town for that greeting card or needed item. The shop is a popular stop for visitors to SCV and an increasing number are visiting from neighboring communities.

Government Affairs

The principal objective of the Government Affairs Committee is to provide members of the community with information about government and politically-oriented activities affecting their interests as residents of the Town of Oro Valley, Pima County and the State of Arizona. These include, but are not limited to, providing information on local and state legislative initiatives, tax and related budget issues, health and safety matters, management of scarce water resources, facilitating voter registration, arranging for candidates for election to public office and for elected officials to meet with residents to talk about issues of particular interest. The Committee has made a special effort, in cooperation with local officials, to promote a greater appreciation for the history, unique characteristics and future plans of the Town of Oro Valley of which SCV is an important component. All Committee activities are politically neutral and unbiased.

Neighborhood Pride

The Neighborhood Pride Committee was formed in November 2005 as an Advisory Committee to the Board of Directors. The committee's purpose is to promote compliance of individual homeowners and selected common areas with the governing documents in order to maintain property and aesthetic values for all residents and potential buyers. The committee has 14 dedicated volunteers who, at our monthly meetings, receive training on possible infractions of the governing documents. On a rotational basis, members in teams of two are assigned to tour a section of the community to report any infractions. Since this committee was formed, the community has never looked so good. Many times residents, and especially new potential buyers, have commented on how wonderful the community looks and how well the yards are kept. It is hard to believe from the looks of the community that Sun City Vistoso is celebrating 20 years.



Posse

The Posse is almost as old as Sun City Vistoso. It was started by Del Webb, who had large trailer loads of construction supplies stored both in and near SCV. It was called the Posse Club and was not formally a part of the Association. Members used their own vehicles to patrol the construction storage areas as well as the community, because there were no funds available. Then the OVPD donated discarded police cars. Many had over 115,000 miles on them. Since then, the Association has paid for the gas and upkeep of the Posse cars. The money for Posse caps and ID badges was first raised by delivering the SCV telephone books.

On July 1, 1996, the Posse became a part of the Association. Originally, the Posse patrol shifts were 8 PM-Midnight and Midnight-4 AM. In March 1998, first shift was changed to 8-11 PM and the second shift to 11 PM-2 AM.

Sun City Vistoso has had the lowest crime rate in Oro Valley, and one of the lowest in Arizona. The Posse is a bona fide Neighborhood Watch Program and is the most successful organization of its type in southern Arizona. Most communities rely on paid patrols which cost their residents between \$80,000-\$200,000 a year. The SCV Posse cost is less than \$15,000 annually.

Properties

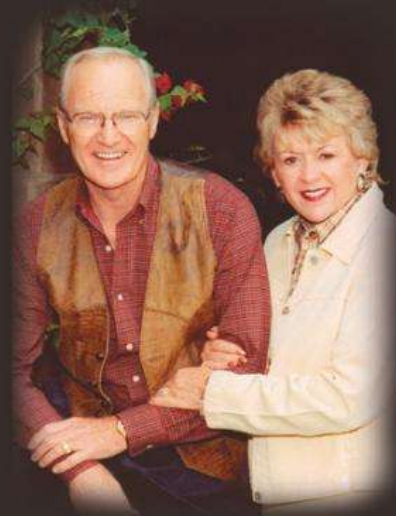
We don't know when the Properties Committee was started, but it must have been one of the first Standing Committees. Its mission is to regularly inspect all facilities and grounds to identify problem areas.

We are a seven-person committee with up to four alternate members. We meet once a month although our members take on assignments that require additional time and action.

Most recently, the committee was involved in the 2006-2007 renovation of the Craft Complex by means of architectural and engineering recommendations.

We are a very active committee, always looking for ways to improve facilities and keep it sparkling.

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Publicity

Marketing/Publicity is an advisory committee that serves at the pleasure of the Board of Directors. It reports directly to them at each BOD meeting and through monthly reports via the Tipster. The Committee has 10 members and two alternates.

Although the Committee does not have a budget, it does assist in development of an annual marketing/advertising plan which is implemented by the administration's Communications Specialist. From time to time the Committee makes proposals to promote our community for the express purpose of attracting new residents and enhancing property values.

The Committee serves as an umbrella for a highly motivated, volunteer subcommittee known as Ambassadors. These dedicated individuals, many of them couples, conduct tours of SCV facilities and, often, are the initial contacts to interface with drop-in visitors and others who inquire about life in Sun City Vistoso via the internet, advertising, news articles, mail and telephone.

Through a cadre of writers, an ongoing flow of information is disseminated to newspapers, magazines and broadcast media before, during and after events.

A subcommittee also maintains close relations with local media and realtors. All meetings are open to residents.



Solar-Green Energy Task Force



Perhaps the most recent group formed by the SCV Board of Directors, the Solar-Green Task Force was established in May 2007. Its mission is to assist in the education of SCV homeowners and staff members in energy, water and other conservation-related subjects. Primarily, these ideas are to be distributed through a monthly Tipster column, special notices, lectures, etc. Homeowners have shown a high level of interest in the conservation subject. This interest resulted in a January 2008 invitation to all southern Arizona homeowners to attend an Energy Conservation Exposition (EXPO) sponsored by the Task Force and held in our auditorium. This event included 22 vendor exhibits on a wide variety of conservation subjects, items and ideas, plus the display of the U of A Solar racecar. Attendance was considered exceptional with visitors from Green Valley, Tucson, Marana and Oro Valley. This is another example of Sun City Vistoso's interest in making our unique community a proud demonstration of active adult living.

Tipster Editorial

The Tipster is our local monthly publication which covers SCVCAI, its organization, clubs, recreation and craft activities, and outside services that promote the general welfare and are of interest to our residents. The publication, which began in 1989, is prepared by a dedicated staff with each issue being reviewed by an editorial staff of 12 to 15 residents.

The Tipster began as a black-and-white publication, was for several years edited by the Activities Director, progressed to a two-color publication printed by Alpha-Graphics and eventually into the four-color publication it is today. We run approximately 2,800 copies per month, reduced to 2,600 copies in the summer months.

The January 2008 issue was edition 235. The staff and editors constantly strive for improvement with more pertinent news items and more color photographs depicting life in Sun City Vistoso.

Greg Mattox, GRI

Associate Broker
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Library

A library didn't exist at Sun City Vistoso 20 years ago. In 1988 three residents established a library in the current Gift Shop with 35 paperbacks and a set of cookbooks. Due to continuing growth, the library moved to new quarters many times; in 1989 to a shared space in the Hopi Room with the Billiards Club, in 1990 to the Weight Room, and in 1996 to the Desert Oasis when a computer inventory program was implemented, with over 3,500 items in the collection.

Because of this growth and with the formation of a Friends of the Library organization, the library was able to plan for another expansion and move to the newly renovated Vistoso Center in 2001.

Today, the all-volunteer staff serves the residents with a library with over 20,000 items including hardcover, paperback, large print and reference books, audios, videos, puzzles, and magazines. The Friends of the Library continues to provide funds for new materials, equipment and furnishings through membership dues and fund raising events.

Friends of the Library

In 1997 the library staff knew they needed more space, funds, and people to advocate for the library. Thus was born the Friends of the Library, a subcommittee of the library. Fund raisers such as the Book and Author Luncheon, bridge games, used books and book bag sales, bingo, concerts, a play, and poetry readings resulted in almost \$13,000. Purchased were resource books, a card catalog file, computer, printer, desk and chairs for the study area.

When the library was given extra space in the Vistoso Center, FOL provided 25 custom bookcases and furnishings. We continue to support library needs, and recently purchased window coverings, a computer table, an inventory computer program, and hosted two free speaking events.

FOL has hosted recognition events for library volunteers. It has been a pleasure working with library staff and dedicated volunteers.

Costume Room

The Costume Room started more than 12 years ago. We had some beautiful costumes and no one wanted to take them home because of lack of storage space. The Administration donated several racks and a small space in the cart barn. Just like rabbits, we multiplied and more space was needed. From rental money more racks were purchased and we were given the old office where the library was in the Desert Oasis. An array of dance costumes from the Holiday Shows and Variety Shows were in abundance. There are animal costumes of every kind, along with gorgeous dresses, hats, gloves, shoes, purses and accessories. There is also theme costumes for Mexican, Chinese, Japanese, cowboy, and many theatrical accessories.

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FEATURES

They Came, They Golfed, They Stayed

As Sun City Vistoso celebrates its 20th anniversary, this is the first in a series of articles saluting its earliest residents, affectionately referred to as "Trailblazers." By Rich Smith



"We made some kid at Sears famous," chuckled Annamae Dugan, reminiscing about when members of her family bought five refrigerators, washers and dryers, all on the same day. The year was 1987 and the reason for the volume purchase was that five of 11 Dugan brothers and sisters had bought homes in Del Webb's budding development, Sun City Vistoso. Golfers all, the Dugan's were always close-knit, although not geographically. Some were from the Chicago area, others called New Orleans and Houston home.

The family was accustomed to getting together in Chicago for golf outings. "The mountains surrounding Rancho Vistoso were the main reason for the clan's decision to put down roots here. There was, however, a spread of several years before all members would be old enough to retire here," said Annamae. "It was a calculated decision for a retirement home and a love of golf," explained John Dugan.

Paul Tatz, CEO of Del Webb, stated that it was the first time five members of the same family had purchased homes in the same Del Webb community. Jokingly, Paul stated they were going to call the community "Duganville." Their initial purchases were for lots in Unit #3, the first area developed. "There was nothing to see," Annamae explained. "You just stood on your lot and all you could see was mountains." The homes were rented until each family moved to Tucson.

What was the area really like 20 years ago? "Well, if you wanted a can of peas for a salad, the nearest grocery store was at Oracle and Magee," said Annamae. "Tangerine was almost a dirt road and the road signs read, 'Watch for Cattle.'" John noted that the present weight room is where the original library was located. "The library continues to be the best entertainment here. Best of all, we enjoy sharing time with our family and the good friends we've made in Sun City Vistoso," said Annamae.



Twenty-One Years and Counting

By Rich Smith



In describing what Sun City Vistoso was like in 1987, Trailblazer Mary Ann Stock likes to invoke the words of the late Frances Staley, another Trailblazer "There are 369 of us now, but someday there will be only one," she said. Mary Ann and husband Ed are bested by only one other family as the longest tenured residents of our community. Thelma and Phil Bishop hold the record, with Frank and Mickie Harris coming in third. "But," Ed points out, "we moved in the morning and the Harris's in the afternoon, so we beat them out for second place."

What was it like here twenty-one years ago? Ed says cows nibbled at the edge of his golf course lot at 14600 N. Chalk Creek Dr., near what started out as the 11th hole, which flipped to become the second hole for a while, then reverted back to being the 11th hole again.

The golf course was up and running as Del Webb marketed Sun City Vistoso as a golfing community, and there was a waiting list for golf course lots. But, according to Mary Ann, the real estate market in Arizona then was boom or bust. "Everything was going up in \$5,000 increments." However, during a temporary slump, three people on the waiting list for golf course lots cancelled and the Stocks suddenly owned a lot. Fortunately their home in Downers Grove, IL, sold in two days.

About that time Del Webb sponsored trips to Ft. Huachuca and Mt. Lemmon, plus tailgate and pool parties for new residents who, incidentally, were sometimes recruited for cleanup of construction debris on the golf course in return for free beer. The first 100-200 residents were involved in everything, including appearing in golf course TV commercials for the new community.

It's been 20-plus years for Mary Ann and Ed—golf, swimming, and the Villanellas among other pursuits. The majesty of snow-capped mountains that originally attracted them here instead of the Sun Cities to the north are still here, but the moos on the golf course are only a memory.

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STEVE MOONEYHAM



Special Employees

We are fortunate to have such a dedicated group of employees. However, there are four deserving special recognition as they have been here since the beginning of Sun City Vistoso:

MARY CUNNINGHAM, Common Area Maintenance Supervisor was hired in August 1986. As a golf course maintenance worker, she learned about desert vegetation working directly with Greg Nash. She was later promoted to Golf Course Common Area Supervisor and is now responsible for all Common Area Maintenance

MAX CRUZ, Social Hall Monitor was hired in September 1986 as a monitor for the Sports Complex and Social Hall. As activities increased in the Social Hall, this became his full responsibility. He oversees these rooms for club and social activities

NORMA MEYERS, Vistoso Center Secretary/Receptionist was hired in December 1986. The first "Hostess with the Mostess," greeted visitors and prospective buyers at the original Del Webb Sales Office. She was promoted to Secretary/Receptionist in the Social Hall Administration Offices and now performs her most important duties at the Vistoso Center.

PATRICK BOULTON, Controller, was hired in October 1987. Originally hired as Assistant Golf Professional, he worked in the Pro Shop until 1990 when he transferred to accounting as a Accounting Assistant. In 1996 he was appointed Controller.

General Managers

1987-1988.....	Billie Jo King
1989-1990.....	Pam Hecker
1991.....	Kay Zargarec-Martin
1992-1995.....	Robert Key
1996-2000.....	Rob Felix
2001-present.....	Scott Devereaux

Heroes Among Us

The SCVCAI Board of Directors adopted a new program July 1, 2001 designed to honor residents who make extraordinary contributions to our community. Entitled the Heroes Among Us Program, one or more community member(s) will be recognized and honored each year. Honorees typically, but not exclusively, do not hold prominent SCVCAI positions or receive other formal recognition for their efforts.

2001.....	Bob Wynne
2002.....	Joan Martin
2003.....	Gay Russell
2004.....	John Greenway
2005.....	Jinnie Wilson
2006.....	John Allen
2007.....	Carol Wittels

LISTS

Board of Directors Officers

Year	President	Vice President	Secretary	Treasurer
1995	Jim Stoetzel	Cleo Scheyli	Doug Weiford	Doug Weiford
1996	John Wickham	Vern Bussard	Vi Mattox	Doug Weiford
1997	John Wickham	Dan Cain	Vi Mattox	Carl Stoltenberg
1998	John Wickham	Dan Cain	Dan Griffen	Carl Stoltenberg
1999	Dan Cain	Carl Stoltenberg	Walt Neighbors	Dan Griffen
2000	Chuck Walton	Walt Neighbors	Jim Haney	John Merrill
2001	Jim Haney	Ed Pendrys	Jane Arndorfer	John Merrill
2002	John Merrill	Jane Arndorfer	Mary Carr	Michael Kaye
2003	Michael Kaye	Mark Wittels	Sue Franklin	Bob Rubino
2004	Bob Rubino	Helen Kirk	Gay Russell	Jerry Natt
2005	Bob Rubino	Jim Ostheimer	Gay Russell	Jerry Natt
2006	Don Sikkink	Gay Russell	Jane Arndorfer	Jerry Natt
2007	Jane Arndorfer	Sharyn Rafieyan	Bill McCarthy	George Williams

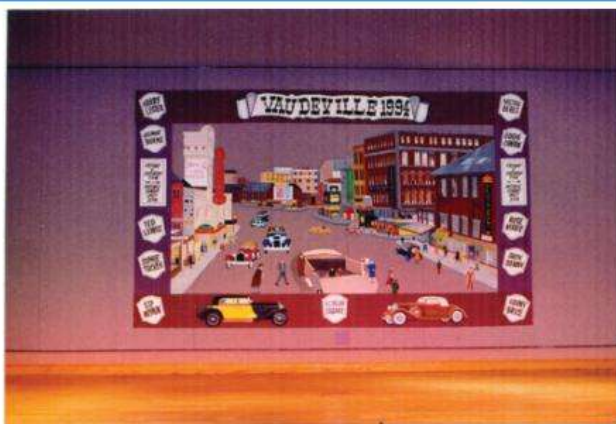
Board of Directors Members

1995	Vern Bussard, Gordon Roberts, Joe Shuman
1996	Gordon Roberts, Cleo Scheyli, Joe Shuman
1997	Vern Bussard, Gordon Roberts, Joe Shuman
1998	Dan Griffen, Walt Neighbors, Carl Stoltenberg
1999	Jim Haney, Walt Neighbors, Ed Pendrys
2000	Jane Arndorfer, Dan Griffen, Ed Pendrys
2001	Mary Carr, Sue Franklin, Michael Kaye
2002	Sue Franklin, Helen Kirk, Allen Pearson
2003	Mary Carr, Helen Kirk, Allen Pearson
2004	Bill Frasca, Jerry Natt, Don Sikkink
2005	Jane Arndorfer, John Sellers, Don Sikkink
2006	Bill McCarthy, Sharyn Rafieyan, George Williams
2007	Steve Taillie, Charles Trull, Tut Tustison

Headlines in 1987 were:

- Iraqi Missile Hits SS "Stark" in Persian Gulf and Kills 37
- 19-Year-Old German Flies Small Plane Into Moscow Square
- Federal Reserve Chairman Paul Volcker Is Replaced by Alan Greenspan
- Prime Minister Margaret Thatcher Is Re-elected for Third Time
- U.S. Supreme Court upholds affirmative action
- Chrysler Corp. offered to buy American Motors Corp for \$1 billion
- IBM releases PC-DOS version 3.3
- Gerber survey finds most popular names for newborns: Jessica and Matthew
- First heart-lung transplant takes place in Baltimore
- Supreme Court rules school teaching evolution need not teach creation
- 200th Anniversary of the U.S. Constitution celebrated in Philadelphia
- "Black Monday" - Dow Jones down 508.32, four times previous record
- Digging begins to link England and France under English Channel
- And... Del Webb Builds Sun City Vistoso in Tucson, Arizona

Did You Know?



This is the stage before we installed curtains. Gloria Kuamme painted eight 4'x8' panels and put handles on the back. Eight people, each carrying one panel, would walk across the stage and stand while props were put in place, then walk off again. Gloria painted all the scenery used for the shows.

Senior Olympians



Sun City Vistoso participated heavily in Senior Olympics during the beginning years. Del Webb supported the event and the Association was a force to be reckoned with arriving in nine busses, outfitted in matching sweatsuits and jackets to face off in bocce, swimming, horseshoes and general support for our Olympians. At one opening ceremonies Sun City Vistoso athletes walked onto the track and circled it before the next team entered the track. We even had our own cheerleaders and cheers. Let's hear it, "Give me a S-U-N C-I-T-Y!"



HISTORY

A Jewel in the Crown of the Desert: The Early Years of Sun City Vistoso

By Jim Williams

- The Del Webb Vision
- Early Construction Begins
- Outdoor Sports Begin
- Clubs and Indoor Activities Start
- Governing the Community
- Growing Pains
- A New Beginning

They came from downtown Tucson, the northwest suburbs of the city, and Phoenix on the warm morning of May 21, 1986. The temperature would reach 90 degrees by midday. They were elected officials and businessmen. Most of them drove north by car from Tucson on the Tucson-Florence Highway (Oracle Road). After crossing the intersection of Ina Road, there were few businesses or buildings to view on their journey north. Besides the barren desert landscape, they saw a Fry's Food Store (where the Wal-Mart Neighborhood Market is today) and the Sheraton El Conquistador Resort. After passing First Avenue, the only structures along the highway included the Pusch Ridge Stables and a few houses. The last traffic light was located at the intersection of Oracle and Magee Roads.



Those journeying north came for a significant ceremony. They turned left off the state highway onto a dirt construction road, the future Rancho Vistoso Boulevard. This road only extended to the worksite. They crossed the Big Wash (no bridge existed at the time) and traveled about one-half mile to the beginnings of Sun City Vistoso. A tent had been erected for a ground-breaking ceremony. Other than the tent, several unfinished golf course holes, and a few trailers, little evidence of a massive housing development yet existed.

The Del Webb Corporation had purchased 1,000 acres of rolling hills in the northern end of Rancho Vistoso, a 7,700 acre master-planned community. Sun City Vistoso was to be the first construction project in Rancho Vistoso. The original plans called for the construction of 2,900 homes for a population of 5,000 persons, a \$250 million project.

The 200 guests were served a western breakfast and listened to country music. The primary speakers at the ground breaking were Iris Dewhirst, the county supervisor representing the area, and Paul Tatz, President of Del Webb Communities, Inc. Supervisor Dewhirst said that "we outlined some stringent rules for protecting the environment and preserving the beauty of our desert. Webb accepted the challenge and is enthusiastically following the rules to a T." One-third the total land area was to be devoted to open space. Sun City Vistoso would be a de-

velopment planned to adapt to the natural environment, and a community of volunteers and active adults.

The Del Webb Vision



The Del Webb Corporation was one of Arizona's largest general contractors at mid-twentieth century. The company built three military bases and a massive Japanese-American internment camp in Arizona during World War II. In the postwar years, Del Webb constructed shopping centers, museums, multi-generational housing developments, industrial parks, hospitals, parks, and two large Las Vegas resorts. But in

1960, Delbert E. Webb, the founder of the corporation, took his organization in an entirely new direction, building communities for active senior citizens.

The corporation purchased thousands of acres in the desert northwest of Phoenix to build Sun City, a place for those over age 45 to live, learn, exercise, and remain active and involved. The company gambled by focusing on twenty percent of the real estate market (senior citizens) and de-emphasizing the other eighty percent. This revolutionary concept of an active adult community was an instant success. More than 100,000 prospective buyers visited Sun City on its grand opening on the three-day New Year's weekend, 1960, and 263 homes were sold on the first weekend of operation. Sun City grew to a population of 46,000, the world's largest active adult community at the time. The Del Webb Corporation began a second senior community, Sun City West near the first Sun City in Phoenix. This community grew to a size of 26,000 by its completion in 1998.

Del Webb's vision of active adult communities was not without its critics. Grey Power senior advocate Maggie Kuhn called them "playpens for wrinkled babies." Others questioned the need for the many rules and restrictive covenants that governed Webb's Sun City. Some urban planners criticized the segregation of the elderly apart from other multi-generational communities with children, cultural diversity, and lower income groups. But, as Lee Eisenberg, author of *The Number*, noted, "for downshifters, Sun City isn't segregation, it's liberation." The community offered fun, a degree of security, and the orderliness that many retirees desired.

In the mid-1980s, Del Webb sent Fred Kuentz, chairman of Del Webb Communities, Inc., the active adult community subsidiary, to Tucson to scout for potential properties. The corporation had previously constructed the Pueblo Gardens development and several downtown office buildings in Tucson. Kuentz selected open land 15 miles northwest of the Tucson city limits in the new Rancho Vistoso master-planned community. This acreage was in an unincorporated part of the county, just north of the then very small town of Oro Valley. Pima County approved plans for Rancho Vistoso's development starting in the late 1970s.

The Del Webb corporate leaders had grander plans than just constructing houses in Tucson, they were building a community. They would construct recreational facilities, meeting rooms, and social halls to encourage the senior

residents to become involved and active in this new community. "Still young, this will be a community of doers... Vistosans will be free to participate in a myriad of Vistoso activities, while maintaining an active role in metropolitan Tucson life, should they so choose," noted a company brochure. Another Del Webb publication asserted that this will "not be the sedentary Golden Years their grandparents talked about, but the active, inspiring years that Del Webb so ingeniously planned 27 years ago."

Early Construction Begins

With ambitious plans in place, the Del Webb Corporation began to build Sun City Vistoso (SCV) in the spring of 1986. The first work focused on construction of roads, parts of the golf course, the recreation center and sample homes.



From the start, serious effort was made to protect as much of the natural and historic environment as possible. On the golf course, more than 500 trees were moved and replanted, with a 90% survival

rate. Two environmental issues slowed construction. First, two Harris hawks nested in a tree on the 12th fairway. Work on that part of the golf course had to wait 55 days until the baby hawks could fly away. Next, a team of archaeologists hired by the managers discovered several Hohokam prehistoric sites on the SCV property. Only one site, a pit house dating back to 1100 CE, was deemed to be historically noteworthy. Construction waited at that location while the archaeologists sifted through the pit house ruins. They saved several pottery pieces and native American implements. The archaeologists also supervised the construction of a replica of a Hohokam pit house near the sales pavilion and made tours available for several months.



Construction on the Mountain Vista Recreational Center began in the fall of 1986, along with building a sales pavilion and several model homes. The Recreation

Center, a 16-acre complex designed in a southwestern hacienda motif, would cost \$5 million to complete.

The sales pavilion and first model homes (located on Crossbow Drive and Desert Butte Drive) were on display at the Grand Opening on January 10, 1987. Sales manager Mick Schofield had hired ten "counselors" to take visitors through the model homes, to help buyers select cabinets, flooring and other items, and to make sales. The architect of the first model homes was Dan Brodsky, who explained that the houses were designed in a modified southern California contemporary southwestern style to fit with architecture in Tucson.

The Silvercreek and Valencia home models were available for inspection at the Grand Opening. They sold for \$111,800 and \$132,800, respectively. Ten models were offered for sale in January 1987 at prices ranging from \$78,800 for a garden villa to \$165,800 for the Topaz model. More than 100 housing units were sold from the Del Webb office at 7400 Oracle Road in December 1986, prior to the Grand Opening. Of these first buyers, 66% already lived in the Tucson area and 13% had previously lived in a Del Webb community. Most of the lots in the first phase of construction were sold by February 1987. Potential homebuyers were brought to the construction site and model homes in buses and small vans rented by the management. For a time, the corporation marketed the community as "Sun City Tucson" because Rancho Vistoso was undeveloped and few knew where it was located.

Serious housing construction began in the winter and spring of 1987. Del Webb managers planned to build a house from start to finish in an average of 76 days. The corporation hoped to begin closing on homes with move-ins by March, but construction was delayed. Advertisements in the *Tucson Daily Star* noted that "this is an opportunity to get in on the ground floor of one of the world's most amazing lifestyles." Del Webb would use 20 local subcontractors to complete the construction of the early homes and community buildings.

By June 1987 the first residents were ready to occupy their homes. The earliest residents included Phil and Thelma Bishop, Bob and Betty Butler, Ed and Mary Ann Stock, Frank and Mickie Harris, Gene and Helen Herschell, Al and Margaret Sorensen, and Al and Pat Torregrossa. By summer, work on the Mountain Vista Recreation Center was progressing, the SCV administrative offices had been started, and the Mountain Vista tennis courts and pool were ready. Those interested in visiting Tucson to consider the purchase of a home were offered a "Vacation Special" at the Sheraton El Conquistador Resort (later the Hilton). They could stay at the hotel for a week at half the regular rate, visit SCV, and play a round of golf.

Conditions were difficult for those early residents. Many of the roads were incomplete and covered with stone and dirt. Residents had to drive to the Fry's Food Store at Oracle and Magee Roads to buy a loaf of bread. Some of the early subcontractors, particularly those in charge of the roofs, did improper installations and work had to be redone, but the corrections were quickly completed. Early resident Vern Bussard remembers getting flat tires from the rough road conditions in the development, and the management quickly paid for two new tires.

Why did the Trailblazers, those who purchased in the first year, move here? Vern Bussard said he "knew the reputation of the Del Webb communities, and that it would not fail." Del Webb's advertisements in Tucson newspapers emphasized their successful experience in launching active adult communities. Some were impressed by the mountains and the open land north of Tucson. Others were familiar with the Sun Cities in Phoenix, and a number of the early residents had lived in one of them. Some homebuyers were drawn to SCV by the golf course, which was heavily promoted in the corporation's advertising. It should also be noted that this was the only active adult community under construction in Tucson at that time, so SCV faced little immediate competition for sales in the active adult market. But shortly after the Grand Opening in 1987, the Robson Corporation announced plans for the future construction of SaddleBrooke in nearby Catalina

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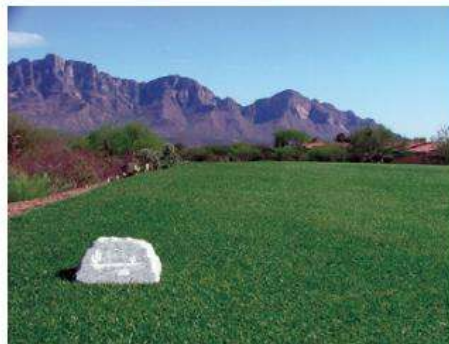
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The grand opening of the Mountain Vista Recreation Center was held in October 1987. At that point, 41 homes were finished and occupied. People from 37 states had purchased homes in SCV. Serenaded by local musicians, residents and prospective home buyers could view the finished multi-purpose rooms and a billiards room (the Kachina Lounge today). The Craft Complex was still under construction. In November, the Vacation Village (the houses on Green Tree Drive today) opened with housing units available for weekly rental by prospective buyers.

Outdoor Sports Begin



Many of the early homeowners came to SCV because they were interested in participating in a variety of sports activities. In the early years of the community, golf, tennis, and other sports were quickly established.

The golf course was designed by Greg Nash, a landscape architect with a degree from the University of Arizona. Nash had previously designed 11 courses for Del Webb communities. He noted early on that "golf is a social event and the heart of an active recreational community." Nash called the layout a semi-target course meant for all levels of golfers. The course, he stated, was not specifically designed for seniors. The hilly landscape made the course more difficult than the flat courses in the Phoenix area Sun Cities. Nash added numerous tee boxes to each hole, an innovation for that time. This was meant to make the course playable for any level of golfer. He also noted that "when they play hole number 9, which I consider a challenge, maybe I should go far away!" The

SCV course was also designed with environmental concerns in mind, with preservation of the existing landscape a high priority.

The first ceremonial balls were hit by Ben and Catherine Berg in October 1986, and nine holes were open for play later that year. The first pro was Mike Williams, formerly assistant pro at one of the Sun City West courses. The greens fees were \$25 for 18 holes and \$14 for 9 holes. Since no homeowners occupied their houses at this point, most of the golfers were residents of other developments in the Tucson area or potential buyers.

To publicize the golf course in the Tucson area, the corporation organized a professional golf tournament on the new course. Held in April 1987, the PGA Senior Skins Game included notable senior pros Billy Casper, Gay Brewer and Gene Littler. Former Master's champion Art Wall won the \$10,000 first place prize.

As residents moved into their homes over the summer of 1987, the golf program expanded. The Double Eagle Restaurant (later the Café) opened in the fall, with daytime and evening dining available every night of the week. Men's and women's 18 hole associations were formed in November, and a women's 9 hole group followed a month later. The first members' golf tourney was held in October of that year. At that point, the only golf problem was the occasional group of range cattle that wandered from neighboring open lands onto the course. The Del Webb personnel had to gather the animals and escort them off the course!



in lap swimming programs during the first year of operation. A number of SCV people completed the 50-mile Red Cross swim program in the first year.



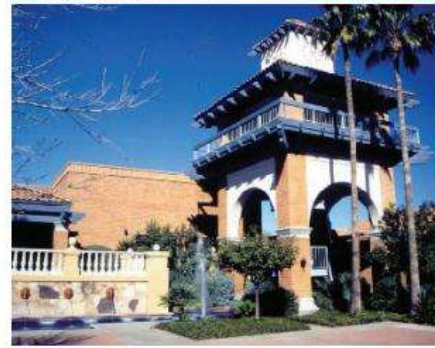
ladies' tennis, both offered one morning a week.

Other outdoor exercise activities included shuffleboard/bocce courts that were available after October 1987, a fitness walk program, and the mini-golf course. The mini-golf course opened in March 1988, and a tournament was held for residents in April.

With the pool open in the summer of 1987, an active swimming program soon took shape. The pool was open from 10 AM to 9 PM daily, with kids swimming permitted from 10 AM to 1 PM. Many residents participated

Tennis was also available in the mid-summer of 1987. The courts near the Mountain Vista Recreation Center were completed in the summer of that year. By March 1988, programs for this sport included men's tennis and

Clubs and Indoor Activities Start



University of Arizona football games. That same summer, swim parties and concerts were held at the new pool. The squash/racquetball court was available for use that fall. The first club, the Bridge Club, was formed in November 1987, and card playing rooms were available Monday through Saturday.

SCV soon began to offer classes at the Mountain Vista Recreation Center in many areas of interest. An exercise class began in December 1987, followed by conversational Spanish and ballroom dancing classes at the beginning of the next year. By February 1988, classes in tennis, organ, watercolor, sketching, and home interior design were also being held. Other classes added later that year included oil and acrylic painting, lapidary, water aerobics, billiards, and stained glass.

The Del Webb management encouraged residents to create clubs to match their interests, and several organizations were formed in 1988. These included the Travel Club, the Book Exchange Club, a Singles club, and Bible Study.



The Craft Village complex became available for resident use in early 1988. The wood craft shop and sewing room were the first to open for use. By April, other craft rooms were available, including lapidary, ceramics, art, and a multi-purpose craft area. Each of these was in use several days per week. In June and July, summer twilight classes were held in the evenings to introduce residents to the many crafts available at SCV.

A number of community-wide activities were established in the first two years and some have survived to the present. The first SCV Arts Fair was held on April 9-10, 1988. A Fourth of July concert was provided, and a Garage Sale was organized for November of the same year. The first Red Cross blood drive was held on August 5, 1988. Because no local church existed nearby, Easter and Christmas services were provided in the Social Hall. At Christmas, resident volunteers decorated the Social Hall with lights and extension cords from home.

Del Webb encouraged the new residents to get involved in volunteering. A group called the Litter Lifters was formed to pick up trash on the golf course. Many early residents volunteered to serve as unpaid monitors at the Mountain Vista Recreation Center. Also, a large number of residents offered to start clubs and other activities. A

community food bank drive to aid the needy was held during the 1987 holiday season.

By the end of 1988, a true community was in the making. Most of the early residents participated in clubs, indoor and outdoor sports, crafts, and community-wide activities. In that sense, part of Del Webb's vision had been accomplished within 18 months after the first residents moved into the development. Many of today's clubs and activities were already up and running!

Governing the Community

Active adult communities are at first completely owned and controlled by the developer, in this case, Del Webb Communities, Inc. Under the original by-laws submitted by the corporation, the company held three votes in the Association for each lot still unsold. The owners of each purchased home were entitled to one vote. Del Webb's voting rights were to cease to exist in 1995 or prior to that date if the homeowners' votes equaled Webb's votes. The first meeting of the Association was to take place in January 1992, or when 51% of the units had been sold.

The original by-laws established the Association's power to assess annual homeowner fees and to make special assessments. The document outlined voting procedures and the election, terms, and powers of the Board of Directors. They provided for officers of the Association, a general manager, committees, and the formation of chartered clubs. The first officers and board were put in place with incorporation in January 1987, and association offices were located in the Mountain Vista Recreation Center at that time.

The Del Webb Corporation worked quickly to involve a number of residents in governing the community. By February 1988, two residents began serving on the Architectural Review Board. The corporate managers asked for volunteers to serve on the SCV Community Association. Frank Butrico and Carol Ward were the first residents chosen by management to serve on that Association. Three company representatives held the majority on that board in April 1988. The Association set the annual homeowner dues at \$235 per year, and an annual golf pass could be purchased for \$400 per year (with an additional \$165 annual cart fee).

By the end of 1988, the following committees had been established: Finance, Architectural Review, Consumer Referral Services, Deed Restriction Enforcement, Properties, Clubs, and Resident Activities. At that time, Del Webb management held majority membership on most of the committees, but with the intent to gradually involve more homeowners. Early residents note that they had little real impact upon decisions in those days. The Del Webb people listened to their ideas but frequently ignored them.

The Del Webb organization developed a series of publications to communicate about governance and other issues. The first resident newsletter, called *Neighborhood News*, was a two-page mimeographed publication first issued in August 1987. This newsletter included lengthy biographical sketches of the new residents, information about coming activities, and clarifications of community regulations.

The first *Tipster* was published in August 1988. Like the *Neighborhood News*, it originally was a two-sheet mimeograph full of activities, new clubs, and information for newcomers. Shortly thereafter, the Association published a directory and expanded the *Tipster* to four pages with the still popular inserts!



Webb lent the group two of them. Because of the small population, few people were available to cover the Posse shifts. Volunteers had to drive alone, covering miles of gravel roads in the dark.

Growing Pains

With any undertaking as large as a 2,488 unit housing development, some problems were inevitable in the first years. There were complaints about construction noise, debris, and related inconveniences. Some problems were more serious than others.

Throughout 1987 and 1988, the new residents were plagued with unexpected high rates when using the local telephone system. Every telephone call to Tucson was assessed as a toll call! The residents signed a petition, addressed to Del Webb and the phone company, asking that the problems with toll calling and the local rate structure be resolved. U.S. West, the phone carrier for the area, investigated the problem but did nothing immediately. Several residents then took the petition to the Arizona Corporate Commission in Phoenix. The Commission quickly ruled that the U.S. West rates were exorbitant, and the residents received reasonable rates by 1989.

Another serious problem involved the annexation of Rancho Vistoso by Oro Valley. The plans for Rancho Vistoso and the SCV development had been approved by Pima County. Rancho Vistoso was then in an unincorporated area of the county. The Del Webb management hoped that Oro Valley would annex Rancho Vistoso and SCV. The issue of annexation was brought to the Oro Valley Town Council in January 1987. The developers in Rancho Vistoso, including Del Webb, wanted annexation to occur so that zoning approvals and building permits could be issued more quickly. When Oro Valley citizens (then about five thousand in number) heard that annexing Rancho Vistoso would expand their population by 34,000 newcomers, many strongly objected. They hoped to keep the small town atmosphere that was present when Oro Valley was founded in the 1970s. Many of the locals feared losing political control to the many future residents of Rancho Vistoso.

The Oro Valley Town Council sided with the developers and annexed Rancho Vistoso in June 1987, just weeks before the first residents moved into our community. But the fight was not over. The Planning Commission of Oro Valley objected to the rapid decision to annex, and the chairman of the commission resigned in protest. A group of Oro Valley citizens filed a lawsuit seeking a public referendum to overturn the annexation. In October 1987, a county court rejected the petition for a referendum. Rancho Vistoso and SCV were permanently a part of the incorporated Town of Oro Valley. Residents of SCV were now entitled to police protection and other municipal services. Also, the inspection of new homes improved signifi-



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We are Sun City Residents

cantly with more close supervision of construction by the Oro Valley government.

Early residents of SCV were surprised to find they had little or no fire department or ambulance protection. In 1987 the Golder Ranch Fire Department in Catalina had only several outdated pieces of equipment and no medical van. Golder Ranch became involved in a dispute with the Rural Metro Fire Department for ownership of rights to Rancho Vistoso. The dispute was resolved when the Oro Valley government backed Golder Ranch. In May 1989 manager Mike Britt announced that Golder Ranch Fire Department would re-enter Rancho Vistoso as the official fire protection provider.

A New Beginning



Though some minor problems occurred, Sun City Vistoso grew quickly and successfully and the homes sold rapidly. The Del Webb vision of a community of volunteers and active adults did come true. Many of today's clubs, activities and sports were operating in the first 18 months. By early 1989 31 activities were established. The committees of the Association were up and running. Volunteers served as monitors in the Recreation Center and helped organize clubs and activities. Efforts had been made to successfully preserve much of the desert vegetation and land forms. The residents were happy with the community they had chosen. "We knew there would be some growing pains, but it's been just lovely," said Phil Bishop of those early years. Sun City Vistoso was "the creation of a jewel in the crown of the desert," said Jean Pfaff.

Thanks to staff persons Norma Meyers, Patrick Boulton, and Robin Coulter, resident Vern Bussard, the late Jim Kriegh, and others for help in researching this article.



GREETINGS

Below are greetings from our residents and the year they moved into our community.

Beverley W. Bayar, 1995

Dee Busse, 1988

Donald and Ann Dauer, 2000

Priscilla Fletcher, 2000

Dr. Rollan and Carol Gongwer, 2004

Luuk and Nelleke Hellebrekers, 2002

Bill and Jan Leahy, 1995

Marilyn K. Martin, 1991

Dick and Barbara Schmitt, 1996

Carol and Mark Wittels, 1993

Congratulations to each of us who had the wisdom and foresight to relocate to this lovely place and make it home. Thanks to all the volunteers at all levels who keep the heart of our community, the committee/club structure, thriving. Cheers to us all, who flourish here.

Jane Arndorfer

Bought the bare lot in August 1988. The whole block was empty! Wow, look at us now!

Barbara Jenks Beckett, 1989

- Our first publications were the "SCV Neighborhood News", expanded to "Vistoso Views" and renamed the Tipster.
- Our Cafe was called the Double Eagle Restaurant serving breakfast, lunch and dinner.
- For sale promotions our community was advertised as Sun City Tucson. Few had heard of Rancho Vistoso.
- As a fund raiser, residents sold and delivered luminaria kits of 12 bags, candles and sand for \$4.50 to illuminate our streets for the Holidays. Del Webb bought 144 kits to decorate Rancho Vistoso Blvd.
- Lively discussions centered around residents voting not to authorize and pay for street lighting. Volunteers circulated petitions to curtail smoking in community buildings.
- Greenspun Court was originally designated as a church site.

Liana Broadstone, 1988

- A 1986 TV ad - Del Webb was locating in Tucson area.
- Being in a crowded Del Webb office on Oracle near Ina and trying to get close to Receptionist Norma Meyers at the desk to put money down.
- Being driven to a dirt road entrance (the big bridge wasn't finished) to enter Sun City Vistoso.
- At one point we had to get our mail at the Cherry Street station; also UPS was on the south side.
- As it was so costly to call into Tucson, Del Webb installed a phone in the rec center for all to use.
- Two hawks held up construction of the golf course; later on the owls took over that same very large saguaro which is now gone, I believe.

Claire Foreman Casurella, 1987

Congratulations to Sun City Vistoso and all its members on a successful twenty years. Current residents, as well as those who came before you are to be commended for creating such an outstanding community and neighborhood. I am proud to be associated with Sun City Vistoso.

Scott G. Devereaux, CMCA, AMS, General Manager

I lived in a ranch house at Tangerine and Oracle from 1938-1968. My sons attended the nearest grade school at Wetmore and Oracle. There were no paved roads on Rancho Vistoso Blvd.; it was all ranch land with jeep trails, cactus, cattle and coyotes.

Helen Ellis, 2002

Thanks, Sun City Vistoso, for nearly 15 wonderful years.

Ann Fall, 1993

Twenty years of success: Sun City Vistoso athletes advance from simple games to forming clubs to staging tournaments to setting up Olympic Championships!

Sally Flax

In memory of John A. Greenway, 2004 recipient of "A Hero Among Us" award.

Nancy D. Greenway, 1995

Congratulations Scott Devereaux for six and a half years of conscientious and professional service to Sun City Vistoso. I thank him for his patience, steadfastness and perseverance in dealing with community affairs, problems, personnel, and most of all, we senior citizen residents.

Nancy D. Greenway, 1995

I didn't know about SCV until I was hired in July 2001. Having a career background in the resort business I realized I discovered an amazing active adult resort. I am continually amazed by the volunteerism and commend the residents for their continued efforts to maintain such an upscale community during the past twenty years.

Colleen Holland, CMCA, AMS, Director of Operations

Congratulations to one of the finest retirement communities in the USA! I have enjoyed 19 years of new friendships, excellent facilities and activities.

Berton E. Kernahan, 1988

Remember when you had to go to Ina and Magee for milk? Remember when it was a long-distance call to Tucson? I do! We've come a long way since 1987. What a great place to work, live and play in, that's for sure. Thanks to all my friends, neighbors and coworkers who have made my 21 years at Sun City Vistoso so enjoyable for me!

Norma Meyers, 1986

- I remember Rancho Vistoso Blvd. with no buildings between Tangerine and Sun City Vistoso; coyotes, javelina and deer were seen frequently.
- There were a lot of dirt roads in Oro Valley.
- Fry's was the closest grocery on Magee and Oracle.
- The closest church was in Catalina.
- There was little traffic on Oracle and none on Tangerine.
- The Bar Wranglers were playing at the CCC Chuckwagon over behind "A" Mountain.

Roger Misgen

This is a wonderful place to live. Mike and I enjoyed our time in this community, and it is a perfect place for a widow. My thanks to the staff, the board and all who give their time to make Sun City Vistoso special. God bless you.

Marilyn Ringer, 1988

It's a pleasure to work in the community in which we chose to live.

Pam Sarpalius, Program Director SCV
Ray Jerkins, Personal Trainer SCV



FOUNDATION

The items contained under this heading are provided as a service to residents by other organizations that are neither sponsored nor supported by Sun City Vistoso Community Association, Inc. SCVCAI assumes no responsibility or liability for the information contained therein.

The Sun City Vistoso Community Foundation, a separate and independent organization from the Association established in 1998, provides a means through which tax-deductible gifts may be channeled to support qualified health, cultural, educational and charitable needs of Sun City Vistoso and surrounding areas. Gifts may be made at any time by check, in stocks or by gifts-in-kind to the Foundation, 1565 E. Rancho Vistoso Blvd., Tucson, AZ 85755. Call 825-6764.

In 1998 Sun City Vistoso residents Rolly Fenz and Jack Johnson founded the Sun City Vistoso Community Foundation to provide financial support for qualified health, cultural, recreational, educational and charitable needs of Sun City Vistoso and the surrounding community. To date, the generosity of over 1,700 residents and friends has generated more than \$500,000 in gifts to meet ever-expanding needs.

In addition to grants, the Foundation sponsors several community events, none of which are fundraisers: the Annual Picnic since 2003; Shred-it first appeared in 2006; HazMat debuted in 2007; Sharpening in January 2008. The increasing levels of giving, sharing and helping have become powerful elements in the evolving character of our fine community.

A GOLFING COMMUNITY

Sun City Vistoso Golf, 1985 to Today

Del Webb was a man of great vision. He recognized what people wanted when they retired and began building communities around those needs. In the beginning Del Webb built very few communities without golf courses; they were the backbone of his community. He was keenly aware that golf courses added great value to the community.

In 1985 Del Webb began construction of Sun City Vistoso, by laying in the golf course. The golf course served as the primary marketing tool attracting those who wanted to play golf and those who recognized the investment value of the course. An extremely large percentage of the new home buyers were golfers as witnessed by the number of golfing members. At times we had over 700 annual pass holders and obtaining a preferred tee time was challenging. Del Webb kept the rates low and maintenance high, all to sell his community. And sell it he did. Many bought here during that time for that reason.

The golf course has almost 200 acres of open space, comprising one-fifth of the entire community. It meanders through the community providing space for wildlife to thrive and traverse. The Board has kept the facility open to everyone, even though most golf courses are closed to nongolfers. Why? Because it remains the community's largest asset and its most marketable amenity.

Everyone benefits from the golf course, whether they hike it, ride it, play golf or just live in Sun City Vistoso. It adds the tranquil feeling of the out-of-doors, cools the air and adds approximately 20% to each home's value, whether on the course or not.

Today the golf course is home to about 400 regular participants and another 100 who play less regularly. Yet, over 1,000 of our residents use the golf facility at some time during the year. We have completed a golf course renovation, added a beautiful fountain and a remodel of the Café which have added great ambience and beauty to the community. The course remains the focal point for visitors and prospective residents.

The next time you drive home or walk outside, look around and smell the grass; your golf course is right around the corner, ready to serve you as a place for exercise or relaxation. Del Webb knew what he was doing, didn't he?



Golf Advisory

The mission statement of the Golf Advisory Committee, one of five Standing Committees in the Sun City Vistoso community, states that the Committee, in concert with the Director of Golf, will assist the Board of Directors in developing plans and programs intended to increase participation in the Association's golf program, maintain and improve the overall condition of the golf course, maximize the availability of tee times for members, establish fee schedules necessary to meet operating expenses and generate increased revenue from programs such as outside tournaments.

The Committee is composed of one member from each of the four men's and women's 9 and 18-hole golf clubs and two members-at-large. The Committee meets on the first Wednesday of each month and at special meetings as needed. At these meetings there are reports from the Course Superintendent and the Director of Golf; action is taken in accordance with our mission statement.



Men's 18-Hole Golf Club

The SCV Men's 18-Hole Golf Club was formed in January 1988. It promotes general play, weekly events, tournaments and social activities for members and friends. All competitions require a modest entry fee; these monies are paid to winners in the form of Pro Shop gift certificates, making the Men's Club the Pro Shop's largest source of revenue. The number of golfers and Club members reached a high point in the late 1990s when 160 men would start the Wednesday event with two five-somes on every hole except on par threes. "Burger Bashes" are held quarterly, attended by combatants of the day's event and others who wish to associate with the membership. The Men's Club served as the Greens Committee; it was replaced by the Golf Advisory Committee.

Over the twenty years of its existence, its members have formed lasting friendships.



Men's 9-Hole Golf Club

The Sun City Vistoso Men's 9-Hole Golf Club began in 1991, five years after the Golf Course opened in 1986. The Club first began in the summer of 1987 with a small group of friends who played regularly.

After several years of informal play, the members submitted an application for Charter to the Association on January 27, 1992. The original membership of 55 men elected as its first officers: Pres., Roy Richards; Sec., Stan Bober; Treas., Bill Kelly; Club Historian, Bill Spector who faithfully described and preserved the Club's beginnings. To our knowledge, Ray Jones and Chris McClure are the two remaining charter members as of February 2008.

Membership has ranged from over 100 to as few as 50 over the years. At present the Club has 74 men playing regularly. We meet monthly to conduct Club business and to enjoy each other's company with occasional "burger bashes!" We have weekly games and awards, and an annual tournament. We also play with the Lady Niners in an annual "Guys and Dolls" golf match followed by a luncheon and awards ceremony.

Sun City Vistoso Women's Golf Club

The Vistoso Women's Golf Club began in October 1988 with 32 charter members. The following charter members are still Sun City Vistoso residents: Virginia Houserman, Jane Hyland, Peggy Shellman, Carol Ward, Virginia Kirkwood and Elayne Miller.

Dues in 1988 were \$25 pp with \$10 going to AWGA handicapping. The remaining \$15 went into the general fund. Participation fee for weekly Tuesday play was \$1. When playing in a special event, we voted to increase the fee to \$2. There was a \$5 fee for riding with someone if you were unable to reciprocate. All players used the gold tees. We now have the choice of red or teal tees.

The board, then as today, consisted of seven members. The first President was Beverly St. Pierre. There were three categories of members: Class A, owners; Class B, buyers with homes under construction and Class C, renters. Class A members were the only ones entitled to vote or serve on the board.

SCVWGC has changed throughout the years, but we still maintain the initial concept of the group to enjoy and support the game and each other.



Lady 9ers

Sun City Vistoso Ladies 9-Hole Golf Club was chartered April 1988 with 87 members. The purpose of the club was to encourage organized golf for the women at SCV and to promote fellowship among the members. Club play was Thursday mornings, and the front and back nine sides were played alternately. In May 1990 the club joined the AZ GHIN System and held its "First Club Championship." During 1994 we had the "First Invitational." Later other tournaments were added: "Guys and Dolls" with SCV 9-Hole Men's Club and "Rally for the Cure" with SCV Ladies 18-Hole Club. Our 2003 Club Champion and Club Low Gross Champion won the AWEA State Medallion 9-Hole Tournament for both "First In Flight" and "Overall Championship," our 2007 Club Champion and Club Low Gross Champion won the AWEA State Medallion 9-Hole Tournament for "First In Flight."

CLUB AND GROUPS

Art League

The Sun City Vistoso Art League, formed in 1998, is an umbrella group of the various art clubs meeting in Catalina Vista. Bob Mulhrad signed the charter for the new League as the first president from 1999-2000. Subsequent presidents of the League were Dave Dame, 2000-2001; Charles Broehl, 2001-2003; Nadine O'Donovan, 2004-2005; Judy Bjorling, 2005-2007. Nadine O'Donovan is the current president.

The Art League plans the art show in the Social Hall and also supports various art groups. Initially, the groups included the Fine Arts Studio, Etching-Printmaking, Sculpture and Watercolor. The Art League currently speaks for over 100 artists and additional groups. It supports an artistic environment and appreciation for the arts among residents.

Fine Arts Studio

The Fine Arts Studio began its life in 1994 when Regina Hall, an accomplished artist, offered to have a class on Color Theory. Several members met each week and decided to encourage artists of different media to collaborate and discuss their work, agreeing to have a demonstration once a month. Other original members were Neil Borgquist, Michael and J. V. Burke, Joan Danielson, and Dave Dame.

The class shared space with the Clay Club in the Craft Complex. In 1996 Catalina Vista was completed, providing space, equipment, and an incentive to expand the group. Artists using various media met and established a time of critique, evaluation and encouragement.

The purpose of the Fine Arts Studio is to provide an environment for creative expression and to guide participants in a better understanding of their work in various media through a critique process.



Watercolor

Original members of the Watercolor Club met to improve skills and subsequently developed a charter in 1996. The first president was Barbara Lutz and our secretary was Pauline B. McCann. Members met and gave class demonstrations in the Craft Complex. Enthusiasm in the group continued, and the Administration determined more space was needed for the growing number of art organizations. In 1996 Catalina Vista was dedicated, and the clubs were assigned time for work in the art room.

In 1997 President Otto Stewart, with other club pioneers, investigated instructional classes held in Tucson. Members drove to classes conducted by named artists, Diane Thibault, Terry Leach, and Zoltan Szabo. Subsequently, the Water Color Club has invited many resident artists to instruct club members at the scheduled time for Watercolor Club at Catalina Vista. Many residents have taken advantage of the instructors and developed outstanding skills.



Astronomy

Dick Beldon organized the club in 1994 and was President until 1996. Lou Perrone and John Cunningham have been members since 1994. Eugene Schaefer was President from July 1996 to June 1997. The most notable activity in 1997 was a Comet Party on April 10, open to the community with refreshments and prizes. Although the Club had 10 members at the time, we had 40 people at the party. Harold Golman, Gene Schaefer, and Jim Lindahl provided telescopes. Other meetings included carpooling to the meetings of the TAAA, visiting Starizona and videos in the Social Hall.

In 1997 Jim Lindahl went to the Grand Canyon Star Party representing the SCV Astronomy Club and set up his scope eight nights at Yavapai Point.



Precept Bible Study

In 1989 Betty Butler and Lois Hillmer began a Precept non-denominational Bible study for women living in Sun City Vistoso, meeting in Betty's home. The class grew and after contacting Kay Warren, Program Director, about space at the Social Hall, we were assigned the Tumbleweed Room. The class grew and our next class location was the Papago Room.

When community management under Dennis Wilkin initiated the chartered club program, the Precept Bible Class became a chartered club.

The close-knit group of members believes the class has grown and flourished because they are a group of women bonded by the common faith in Jesus Christ, although they attend different denominational churches.

Bike Club--Vistoso Cyclists



Nowadays, the Vistoso Cyclists is a club of 100+ men and women who, while sporting flashy orange and yellow custom bike jerseys designed by longtime member Rich Roelke, ride bicycles regularly for fitness, companionship, and adventure. The club was founded in 1992 as the "Sun City Recyclers" by octogenarian Marv Sims, with Bill Dakel, Don Johnson, and others. Meetings were bike rides to the McDonald's at Oracle and Magee or trips on the few paved roads in the Sun City Vistoso/Oro Valley area. By 1994, the club had grown to 40 men and women. Loyal Seidner was an early club president. His spouse, Karen, as social director, became famous for her homemade fudge.

In 2001, the Recyclers became Vistoso Cyclists with Dave Nelson as the president. The ride committee was composed of Jack and Libby Melville and Bob and Donna Mathers. They expanded the distance and number of rides per month. Since its inception, club members have participated in local cycling events and the Senior Olympics. Dave Malkin introduced cycling to his family and now rides with three generations. Julia Zahn rode across America in 2006, as did Bill Phillippi in 2007.

Billiards



Past and current Billiards Club presidents, L-R: Art Wynne, Everett Thomson, Jim Cook, Barney Hall, Mort Mortimer, Ron Craig and current president, Barbara Palacios

In 1993 the billiard players decided to organize. Art Wynne served as the first president. Howard George served as tournament director and instructor. We originally played at the Desert Oasis with 16 members, and four tournaments were held annually. In 1995 we moved into Catalina Vista and acquired a fourth table. After fifteen years, we have become one of the most active clubs in Sun City Vistoso meeting five days a week, 52 weeks a year with nearly 50 members.

We now hold over 20 tournaments per year including the Annual Club Championship. Our members compete annually in the Tucson Senior Olympics and have won numerous gold medals.

The most important thing to remember is that any club is built on the foundation of a dedicated membership. We thank all the members throughout the years who have served and participated in making the Billiard Club the great success that it has become.

Bocce



The SCV Bocce Club began in 1988. In 1989, we became a chartered club with 50 members, playing on three courts. As the popularity of the game grew, so did our membership, to an all-time high of 223 members. Noticing the growth of our club, Del Webb installed two more courts in 1989 and added two more in 1991. We have consistently brought home medals from the Tucson Senior Olympics. We were also medal winners at the Arizona Senior Olympics and the Tri-Cities tournament that included Sun City and Sun City West and Sun City Vistoso (see photo).

Highlights of the last twenty years include: Hosting all or part of the Senior Olympic Bocce Tournaments since

1990; a Del Webb-sponsored trip to Laughlin, Nevada to compete in the Flamingo Bocce Tournament; catering an event for Del Webb at the model homes; volunteering for the annual Special Olympics; Moonlight Madness Tournaments; and fundraisers, such as craft sales, bake sales, ice cream socials, casino trips, and work parties to help refurbish our courts.



Birders Group

The Birder's Group was formed in 1998 by a small group of residents who decided they would like to learn more about the interesting birds in their yards and the surrounding area. The group slowly expanded its numbers, and the bird outings spread out to include the mountains, wetlands and deserts of southern Arizona. We have had some special outings to Bosque del Apache NWR (National Wildlife Refuge) in New Mexico and a trip to the Colorado river and Salton Sea, as well as trips to Garden Canyon in the Huachuca Mountains to see the Elegant Trogan.

Book Clubs



The charter for what has become a popular book club was established around 1990 with the original 15 members. First President, Ruth Miller, tells us that the original meeting place was at Desert Oasis. The club was to have been called First Edition, which would have included the first 25 members.

Should membership rise above that number, the subsequent group would be called Second Edition. Those titles never materialized, so we are just the Book Club.

We meet the first Monday of every month with ample time after to chat about that day's presentation over pastries and coffee. A committee of three volunteers each year makes choices for the next year. There is always a classic, a biography, a mystery and an extensive variety of other books. A volunteer leads that day's book discussion, including background information on the author.

Brewster Auxiliary

Brewster Center is an organization dedicated to providing goods, services and housing for victims of domestic violence.

The Sun City Women's Auxiliary has been supporting The Brewster Center domestic violence services here in Tucson over the past eight years. During this time members have refinished rooms and purchased appliances for the center, in addition to donating each month clothing, personal items, shoes, bedding, household goods for families in need. We send \$250 per quarter to help with food for the shelters.

This past November, in what has become one of SCV's premier charitable benefits, the annual Brewster Holiday Fashion Show and Luncheon drew a record crowd of 281 members and guests. The auxiliary, which has already donated more than \$30,000 to the Brewster Center over the past five years, added another \$2,500 check this year and will add another \$1,589 as a result of raffle sales.

Bridge

Duplicate Bridge

We provide interesting and challenging bridge for experienced players. This is not a ACBL-sanctioned group so Master's Points are not given. Bring your own partner. All monies are paid out in prizes.

Ladies Monday Bridge

The Ladies Social Bridge Club has been in existence for approximately fifteen years. It was started by Betty Jackson and Lorraine Weiss who assembled a group of women together for an afternoon of bridge. The aim of the group was to play bridge in a friendly, non-competitive atmosphere. They purchased the necessary cards, tallies, etc., by collecting yearly dues. Many of the players who had just completed bridge lessons from Penny and Jack Payton found this group to be a step forward in continuing what they had learned. We owe much to the Paytons, who at their own expense, undertook and opened the door to a challenging pastime for so many of us. The group has progressed at all levels of bridge while maintaining the same players' spirit of friendship. We now meet on Monday afternoon with a name change to Ladies Social Monday Bridge Club.

Ladies Wednesday Bridge

Ladies Wednesday Bridge has the distinction of being the first organized group in Sun City Vistoso, according to Max Cruz, monitor in the Social Hall.

The written records have been kept since 1992 and contain the officers, meeting times and places. In addition, they also chronicle the menus of each luncheon, including the colors of the place mats and napkins! At one luncheon in 1992, there were seventy-two members in attendance.

Marathon Bridge

Nine years ago Marathon Bridge started as a fund raiser for the new Sun City Vistoso FOL (Friends of the Library). For several years it was the second largest fund-raiser for the library. It has been a community builder for the many players. Every month one team plays another team at the host home. When all the bridge players left the FOL board, the bridge group just continued on its own, since the new board felt that bridge really did not have anything to do with library activities. Jayne Kuennemeier has run the group for the last nine years with the help of George Holthus, Jerry Cohen, and many others.

Mixed Social Bridge

About 1998, several of us in Sun City Vistoso completed a beginning bridge class given by Penny and Jack Payton. Soon after we formed a group called Intermediate Bridge Class to distinguish us from the beginning or advanced group. About a year later we changed our name to Social Bridge which worked for awhile; then someone suggested we should tell everyone this group was for both men and women.

At that time we were not an accredited club. The first time we applied to the Association we were told there were too many bridge clubs already! Not to be deterred, we applied again the next year and changed our name to Mixed Social Bridge and are now an accredited club.

We have approximately 67 members and average five or six tables of bridge a day. Two days last year we had eight tables!

Practice Bridge

It was about five years ago, during Wednesday afternoon bridge lessons which were taught by the late Toni Abel with Ruth Damlich, that I met Sharna. Sharna was my partner during the bridge play that put into practice the lesson just taught. Sharna said, "I'll never play after these lessons." I was shocked and asked why. She said she wasn't ready to go to any of the bridge clubs. "Just a minute!" I responded. "I think there just may be three others who feel the same way." So Sharna, Peggy, Helen and Elvie agreed to get together and play bridge. Several others joined in and we very gradually grew but are still a small group. Some players stay with us and others go on.

Having met in various centers, we now meet at Catalina Vista. We were at one time asked to leave a preferred room by a Spanish class, because we were too noisy; we were just having a wonderful time! Upon discovery that the Spanish class had a higher priority standing for a meeting room than we did, we learned we had to become a club. Now we are officially a club.

You'll find us on Monday afternoons at 1 PM all year long. All are welcome as long as they have some small acquaintance with the game of bridge. Many of us started out learning bridge several decades ago; the skill does return. Our goal is to encourage confidence in playing bridge for pure enjoyment. An added benefit is finding some marvelous close friends.

Canasta

When Sun City Vistoso was in its infancy, a young lady named Gina May moved here. After she got settled she got bored, didn't know anyone, had no one to do things with, etc. Gina decided to go up to see Receptionist Norma Meyers and ask what was going on around here that she might like to do.

Norma asked Gina what she was interested in and the reply was, "Cards!" Norma asked what kind of cards and Gina said, "Canasta." Bingo! The canasta club was born. Gina was helped with the organization of the club by Annette and Clarence Komaniecki and Mary Luiker. Annette still plays today.

The game was played in the Auditorium with very few players during winter, and even fewer players in the summer. It was decided to play in the evening as some of the people still had jobs. The Canasta Club now meets in the Vistoso Center and usually has a weekly attendance of around 30 people.

Desert Celtic Society

The founders came together in April 1996 to create the Desert Celtic Society. Residents of Irish, Scotch, Welch, Brittany (France) and Cape Breton descent wanted to gain further knowledge of their heritage. Ray Everett, Anna McDonald, Jim Kelly, Tom Colglazier, Betty Bartoszek and several others made it possible.

Over the past few years, we've had presentations including James McBain on Scotland, "Growing up on the Isle of Sky"; Patrick Lavin on Celtic Culture; the Bracken School of Irish Dance, to name a few. In addition, members continue to relate their travels and family history searches which are always of interest to the group.

Ceramic Club

The Ceramic Club had its beginning in early 1988. Del Webb had the Ceramic Room equipped but found nobody to run it. Dot Lehman had some experience, so Del Webb paid her minimum wage to keep the room open four hours each day.

It didn't take long to realize it would be more practical to pour our own molds. An empty room nearby was equipped by Del Webb; Sun City West gave our club their old molds. Dot became a certified instructor, and the Ceramics Club was on the way. Dot's husband, Al, did the pouring of the greenware.

Because Dot was a snowbird, Annmarie Powers was the first president; Pat White was vice-president. Soon Gene Powers and Glenn White joined in the pouring which shows how fast our club was growing.

Our yearly dues were \$6 a year; 20 years later they are still \$6, with no extra charge for firing.

Clay Club

The Clay Club was started in 1989 by former resident, Betty Reichert, and her neighbors. At the annual club fair other interested residents joined the group. To be an official club they needed 15 members. When they achieved that goal, the club charter was written. The Del Webb Association purchased the kilns, a slabroller, pottery wheels and an extruder. During the early years, the studio was shared by several other art groups. Our day was Thursday. Sometimes it was difficult to finish our work when the other groups were in the room.

The club continued to grow and in a few years the other art groups moved to their new space at Catalina Vista and we joyfully had the room to ourselves. Today we have over 70 clay artists busily creating in this wonderful studio. Recently, with the craft complex expansion and remodeling, our kilns were moved to a separate room giving us additional space in our studio to conduct workshops for our members.

VCS (Computer Society)

VCS was started in 1990, officially chartered in 1994, with the goal of assisting our members in using their computers. The membership now consists of over 550 households serving over 1,000 individual members with both PC and MAC computers.

Initially, the club members met in a room in the Craft Complex in small interest groups led by volunteers using a projector. With the purchase of a new building by Sun City Vistoso in 2000, work began on creating a hands-on computer center.

In December 2002, VCS dedicated the Vistoso Computer Learning Center. The center has 16 PCs and 10 MACs. The equipment and software for the center was purchased by the VCS membership and small grants from the Sun City Vistoso Foundation and software corporations. The center is used strictly as a hands-on educational facility. Computer classes, help sessions and at-home mentoring are handled by member volunteers.

Dance Groups

Ballroom--Vistoso Villanellas



On October 11, 1988, the Vistoso Villanellas held their first dance in the Social Hall.

Forty-two people paid \$3 each to attend. The band cost \$250 so Del Webb must have been a cosponsor. Bill and Joann Gibson were the first presidents. Joann had thought up the name Villanellas since she felt Sun City Vistoso homes looked like Villas. The rest is poetic license.

Dances were held monthly except during July and August. Outside dances were held around the pool with the band under the building roof. As more houses were built across the golf course, complaints of noise arose. The Association, Del Webb and the Villanellas jointly bought a portable dance floor that could be installed in the Courtyard, but at the last minute the Association (which was mainly Del Webb at the time) backed out. The Villanellas picked up the Association's third, as well as their own third, and put a surcharge on ticket prices until they had recovered the investment. The floor became the property of the Association.

Cloggers

The first clogging class began October 14, 1996, and consisted of some residents who are still in Sun City Vistoso: Joanne Clem, Stephanie Consalvo, Ruth Hochstein, Dee and Len McIlroy, Fred Morris, Gladys Pincus, Joan Scouller, and Lorna Small.

At the first class we talked about the history of clogging in America, discussed clogging shoes and taps (double and hinged), how to read a cue sheet, and we actually learned two dances, "Americana" and "Battle of New Orleans."

Clogging is an environment where you can stomp your feet, clap your hands, hoot and holler and still be socially correct. We say we clog so our arteries won't.

Names and faces have changed over the years and many different cloggers have appeared in past Christmas shows.

Anne Wilson has remained our instructor throughout the 11 years, working to advance this true form of American Folk Dance. She continues to remind us that we are recreational cloggers, not competition cloggers; therefore we're here to have fun. And fun it is.



Hula

The Sun City Vistoso Hawaiian Tutus (Hula Dancers) was started in 1989 when Frances Staley, Hester Fitzgerald and friends decided to further their knowledge of the dance they learned to love while on a trip to Hawaii. The word Tutu means "grandmother" in Hawaiian, and they are given a great deal of respect.

There have been three teachers over the years: Iraina, Leiola and Lisa who were hired from the outside. Whenever an instructor was lost, classes went on with practice of the dances already learned until a new instructor could be found, a task which wasn't easy. Marietta Fowler, a SCV resident and former dancer in Hawaii, has become the instructor. Classes are free to residents. The group has performed for SCV shows, nursing homes, private parties, club parties, assisted living facilities and the VA. Members of the group love the dance.

Line Dancing--SunLINERS



May 1997 Senior Nationals

L-R: Shirley Estrada, Rheeda Niksich, Norma Mergner, Joan Morris, Fanny DiPaolo, Margaret Witson

People have been dancing in lines (linear, circular or serpentine) for thousands of years. Western Line Dancing became popular in Texas in the early 1970s and is now practiced around the world to Country Western and popular music. Line dancing began in Sun City Vistoso in October 1993, with several ladies who line danced as "The Lively Liners."

In 1994 the SunLINERS club was chartered and held its first dance in March. A year later members performed "A Barn Dance" from *Oklahoma* at the Sun City Vistoso variety show. In 1997 members performed at the Unit 12 Western Hoe Down and for the Senior National Sports Classic (photo). In 2007 members entertained at the Mountain View Retirement home and demonstrated line dances at the Club Fair.

Membership is currently over 100 residents. Line dance lessons are now given Saturday mornings in the Auditorium with practice sessions Wednesday evenings and Thursday afternoons.

Square Dancing--Sundancers



New Years Eve 2008

Early in 1988 on a whim, Ken and Barb Jeffries stopped by Sun City Vistoso thinking it would be a good place to start a square dance club. Billie Jo King, the General Manager at that time, gave approval for Ken to start a club.

The first lesson class was in February 1988 with 36 dancers. When the club was chartered in June 1988; the name "Sundancers" was chosen with Ed and Lil Camilleri becoming the first co-presidents for 1988-1990.

In the fall of 1991, Ron Markus replaced Ken Jeffries as the Sundancers' caller. Ron also cues round dancing which makes him a unique asset to the club.

In the fall of 1995 the Sundancers began sponsoring special square dances, including round dancing, with national callers for a total of 65 events. Sundancers' membership now totals 116.

Western Dancing--Kactus Kickers



The founders of the Kactus Kickers loved Country-Western music and wanted to dance to its beat and rhythm. On June 19, 1990, forty residents adopted their constitution and slate of officers. Afterwards, Rita Clapp, a founder, said she and others picked up some American flags and paraded around the Social Hall waving their flags, announcing the new club to everyone in the area.

Monthly dances were held, except during the summer, and once or twice a year a live band was hired for a big dance. The Club always arranged for lessons. In the 90s, two instructors from Arthur Murray Studio in Tucson came to teach for eight weeks.

Everyone is invited to join Kactus Kickers. Today, we offer live-band dances each year, six or seven free lessons each year, weekly practice sessions and in April, the best barbeque you'll ever attend (free to members).

Day Trippers



February 2006 on a trip to the Greek monastery in Florence the ladies were all required to wear long skirts and cover their heads.

For the past 19 years, Day Trippers has offered residents the opportunity to explore Tucson and many surrounding venues, its theatres and restaurants. In 1988, the ladies would take their own cars, but as the group grew and included men, buses were utilized and more and more people signed up to be part of this friendly, welcoming group. Parties were a common happening. Entertainment became part of the usual fare.

Day trips were the mainstay, but occasionally excursions of several days were met with eager participation. The Albuquerque Balloon Festival, Hon-Dah Resort/Casino, Pinetop, Palm Springs Follies, Debbie Reynolds' Show in Las Vegas, the California coast, as well as the Grand Canyon, Sedona and the Greek Monastery in Florence are a small sampling of many memorable trips. We continue to plan a traveling and entertaining future.

Dinner 'N Show

The Dinner 'n Show Club was created in 2003 after a proposal by the Travel Club for a name, and a mission change was approved. The successful format for these activities was pioneered by Jack Byers who developed many fortuitous contacts with theaters, transportation and restaurants; his leadership has been continued by the current planning committee.

The motto of the club, as it appears on all publicity, is: "Sometimes just a show, sometimes dinner and a show, always a good time!" The club helps many residents, who are unable or prefer not to drive, to attend and enjoy the functions and benefit from the socialization of the group.

The goal of the club is to help all residents to attend a wide variety of entertainment venues, to get the best possible seating, to provide safe transportation and to enjoy a complete meal at the most reasonable cost.

Discussion Groups - Great Decisions

Introduced by the Foreign Policy Association in 1945 with the intent of educating, informing and ultimately engaging citizens in the foreign policy process, the Great Decisions discussion program has swelled to 29 chapters in the greater Tucson area. Recent events, as well as the flow of information regarding foreign affairs, has encouraged citizens to respond to a forum whose stated goals are to bring people together to express their ideas and opinions through debate and discussion.

Jim Huffer formed the Great Decisions Discussion Group in Sun City Vistoso in the spring of 1996 with assistance from Lynn Bernstein and Gordon Danhof. We have met twice a month in the Social Hall/Navajo since, second and fourth Wednesday noons in the brown-bag luncheon format. The group has no formal structure and charges no dues; the only requirement is obtaining a briefing book and having a keen interest. Jack Evert has recently replaced Lynn Bernstein in a co-moderator capacity.

Jim Huffer has served as president of the Tucson Great Decisions Association, Inc. (a non-profit) for a six-year period starting in 2001. This is the largest such group in the nation with a mailing list of 750.

Dog Club--Fido's Friends



In September 2007 the Fido's Friends Club celebrated the grand opening of their dog park. This four-year effort started after retired veterinarian, Bill Abel, moved to Sun City Vistoso. He and other residents saw the need for a pet club and a dog park in our community. In September 2001, this small group received permission to start an interest group called Pet Partners of Sun City Vistoso. The mission of this group was to promote responsible ownership, health and safety, as well as fellowship for pets and their owners. The group grew and in March 2003 became a Charter Club of SCVCAI. It was becoming apparent that the greatest interest and need in the club focused on dogs, so in October 2005 the name was changed to Fido's Friends Club.

In the last few years the club sponsored programs in the community such as "The Handi Dogs," featuring a hearing-impaired man and a woman with physical limitations and their service dogs. Another well-received program was "The Dancing Dog Club of Tucson." There are also open meetings featuring snake aversion training, behavioral training instructors and area veterinarians.

The need continued to rise for a permanent dog park in our community; the 2004-2005 FFC board accepted the two-year commitment to find an area suited for a park and to present this to the SCVCAI Board and residents.



Energetic Exercisers

In 1987, we followed a tape and video, using weights, long poles and floormats. The class was led by class volunteers. Our charter club was established February 9, 1988.

Debbie Wood was our first instructor. She piqued our interest in competing in the Tucson Senior Olympics where our club soon earned the reputation as the seniors to beat.

In 1995 we contracted with Sally Martinez, our current instructor. The class now includes cardio, interval training, light weights, bands and small balls. Toning and balance exercises are especially beneficial for seniors. For several years the class also included step exercises and large balls once or twice a month.

Sally places no limitations on any individual because of age; therefore we have some remarkably fit members who are well into their 80s. The class has grown over the years to over 100 energetic, healthy members, both men and women.

Euchre

Euchre is an offshoot of Juckerspiel, a game that became widely popular throughout Europe during the Napoleonic Era. In the 1800s it became one of the most popular card games in America and Australia. Euchre is the reason why modern card decks were first packaged with jokers, a card originally designed to act as the right and left "bowers" (high trumps). Although later eclipsed by bridge, Euchre is still well known in America and is an excellent social game. Euchre started here in January 2008. We already have 25 members.

Financial Strategies

Financial Strategies discussion group was formed in the spring of 1996 by Jim Huffer, Charles R. (Dick) Schmitt, and Rankin Greisinger with the idea of sharing our resources, wits, and experience for the purpose of being able to manage better our individual investments and to cope with the economy. We meet twice monthly; no dues are charged.

Though we occasionally have a guest speaker from the investment advisor/manager community, we usually meet in an informal open session to discuss a potpourri of topics, beginning with a discussion of recent market action and trends. We bring our own investment ideas to the meeting and research them together, using one of the commercially available programs. Other recent panelists have included Gene Bammel and Bob Rubino.

As a sidebar, we have guided the formation (Joan Eddy initiated this activity in the fall of 1995) of five Investment clubs that were operating according to the guidelines provided by NAIC (National Association of Investors Corp.), where the groups formed into partnerships for direct investment in stocks and did the necessary accounting to their respective partnerships. Only one continues – VIP (Value Investment Partners) with Bob Rubino serving as president.

Garden Club



The Garden Club was organized in November 1990 with Elaine Cohen as the first president. The mission of the Garden Club is to educate, demonstrate and familiarize residents with local flora and to develop friendships during our meetings and trips. Guest speakers and demonstrations, along with refreshments and socializing, are part of our meetings.

Day trips to nurseries, arboreturns, cacti farms and botanical gardens always include a special luncheon.

The Garden Club decorates the Social Hall for Christmas and the holidays as part of our community service. Some of the other services performed in the past have been planting and maintaining the flower beds in the craft area, sports complex fountains and planters at the Social Hall, Desert Oasis and Catalina Vista. The Garden Tours of residents are always a highlight and are open to the community.

One of the most memorable meetings was the Day of the Dead celebration, with costumed procession, altar, authentic luncheon and a guest speaker detailing the history and events.

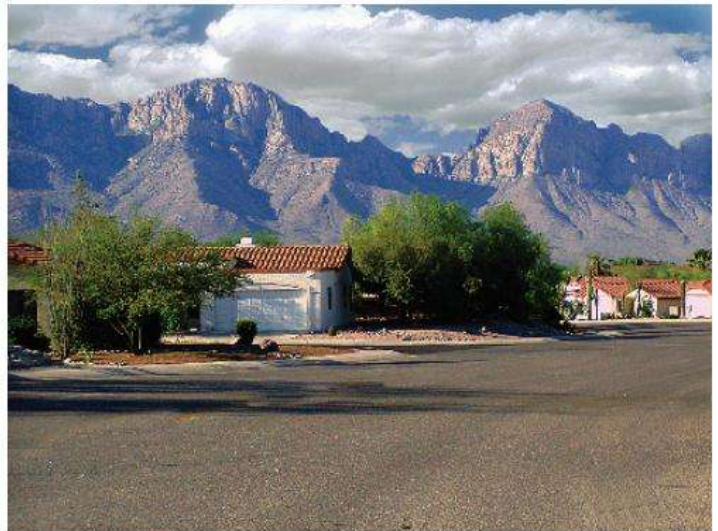
Some additional community services have been providing scholarships to camps for children interested in gardening, plant clinics and workshops for the community, and books donated to the Library.

Gin Rummy



L-R: Phillis Howatt, Don Witteman, Jim Wisda, Marv Kaplan, Elke Oldenburg, John Antliff, Bill Lorenz.

The first gin rummy club was organized by John Antliff in April 1997. The group chose Monday evening meetings, and attendance has generally ranged from six to twelve players at the Desert Oasis. The second club was organized by George Riley in August 2001, originally for men only, on Thursday mornings, but later expanded to include ladies and met three mornings a week, including Tuesdays and Saturdays. George and Bev Riley have also hosted gin rummy workshops for new players in their home, as well as monthly gin rummy dinner parties on Sunday afternoons in the Catalina Vista Recreation Center.



Genealogy Club



Timeline of the Sun City Vistoso Genealogical Society

- May 1990: A "Let's Get Together and Talk About It" meeting was held at the home of Nels Sulouff to discuss starting a genealogy society.
- October 9, 1990: The first meeting of the Sun City Vistoso Genealogical Society took place in the Navajo Room with Nels as president. The club started with 42 members.
- January 1992: \$2 per person dues were instituted to pay the speaker's lunch and transportation costs.
- June 1998: The club held its first annual banquet at the Peppermill Café.
- November 2002: The club was given a research center in the Vistoso Center which now has six computers.
- January 2005: The club received exclusive use of the Havasu Room for meetings and a library, now with over 600 titles.
- January 2008: We have 135 members and continue to hold monthly meetings and programs.

Couples Gourmet

In August 1993, Couples Gourmet Club became a chartered club of Sun City Vistoso. The purpose of the club, then and now, is to enjoy fine foods with friends in this community and to prepare and share recipes from various regions of the United States and the world. The 63 couples on the 1993 roster had large group activities in October and May and held monthly themed dinners in homes. Imaginative gourmet dinner themes included "A Trip to Athens," "Out of Africa," "Crazy for Creole," "Soups, Salads, and Sundaes" and "Men's Treat."

Two current member couples, Lowell and Carol Olson and Jim and Ann Stoetzel, have been participating since Couples Gourmet Club served the first meal. For the first few years, the Tipster featured a cooking tip of the month. Members continue to be informed of coming events through this monthly newsletter.

Havurah



L-R: Corinne Kulick, Eileen Rotman, Al Rotman, Adrian Korpel.

The Hebrew word "havurah" means "fellowship." Many people moving to Sun City Vistoso from distant places found themselves without a network of friends. Havurah was formed as a substitute extended family for these residents. The group celebrates Jewish life through study, observance of holidays and socializing.

At its inception in 1994, there were 66 members; today there are 166. Since holiday celebration is central to Jewish culture, we sponsor a Rosh Hashonah dinner, a Passover Seder, Chanukah candle lighting, and a humorous skit for Purim. Monthly we have a bagel brunch. In the winter season we have a membership party, and in the summer we hold a potluck supper.

Our monthly meetings feature a variety of informative speakers. We sponsor an evening of culture each month, as well as a Yiddish class, where members hone their language skills.



Hiking Club

The Sun City Vistoso Hiking Club was formed in June 1994 and consisted of 35 members. The first hike was on the Sutherland Trail in Catalina State Park. Since then, this very active club has grown to over 300 members and has hiked a total of almost 270,000 miles!

The club provides hikes for all levels of hikers, from a D hike, which is the easiest, to an A hike, which is the most strenuous. During the peak hiking season in the winter, we average about ten to twelve hikes per week. The hikes range from four to twenty miles in length and average about seven miles.

In addition to hiking, the club takes an active part in volunteering to ensure the development and maintenance of trails and facilities on state and federal lands for hikers and others who want to experience the outdoor beauty of Arizona. In December 2003, the hiking club raised \$6,200 to help Catalina State Park purchase equipment needed to recover from the summer floods. In 2007, we raised \$6,000 for the Save Our Sabino initiative to help restore Sabino Canyon hiking trails and roads.

Most of our hikes occur in areas around Tucson. However, we also go on hiking trips to many other parts of the country. We have hiked in the Grand Canyon, Yosemite, New Hampshire, Death Valley, and Alaska, to name a few. In April 2008, a group is going to Big Bend National Park in Texas.

Horseshoes



Jack Howatt and Ray Coleman tossing shoes at the old pits by the Cafe.

Some members play for exercise and enjoyment. Others seek competition to win medals and ribbons.

Ray Coleman received Tucson's Mayor Walkup Commendation for: 1) National Senior Olympics: 2007, third; 2005, second and 2001, fifth; 2) Arizona State, first place, six medals; 3) Tucson, first place, eight medals and 4) Tournament of Class Champion Patches, first place.

Jack Howatt has mastered the game using the 1 1/4 turn. His Minnesota temperament and skills are a perfect fit. Jack has been the glue that has held the club together. He has won first place twice; second place three times and third four times. He has also received two awards for excellence. Jack explained that Del Webb built four horseshoe pits and provided night-lights, so residents could pitch in the evening during the hot summer weather.

Noah (Jim) Johnston plays like an Oklahoma tornado. He hits the peg every time he throws. He has won first place three times, second three times and has five patches.

Ron Knudson enjoys throwing a "3/4 Flop" to perfection. His South Dakota background allows him to be a leader.

Tom Biehler, our friendly giant, tosses a magnificent "3/4 Flop." It can only be described as a thing of beauty.

ILR (Institute of Learning in Retirement)

Inspired by the life-long learning program at the UofA, Drs. Gene and Lei Bammel envisioned a similar organization in Sun City Vistoso. Jane Arndorfer, Milton Damlich, and Sig Olney rounded out the first board in 2003. Since then, the ILR has attracted over 500 members with 82 courses in fields such as philosophy, science, religion, psychology, history, culture and literature. Offerings for individual pursuits have included drawing, Tai Chi, recorder and Native American flute. Weekly Samplers and Short Subjects cover a variety of topics and points of view without advance registration or cost.

The ILR is dedicated to enhancing the lives of residents, providing an environment that leads to learning and lively discussion. The dedication and hard work of many committee members and presenters showcases the large pool of diverse talents and skills in our community. This unique opportunity for learning has become a drawing card for new and long-term residents who value intellectual stimulation.

Investment Club--VIP

The formation of VIP Investment Club was led by Ace Ranslem in 1995. The first meeting was held on September 25, 1995, and club rules were agreed upon. There

were 31 people who attended, with 25 agreeing to membership. Officers were: Pres., Ace Ranslem; VP, Ed McCann; Sec., Jean Holak; Treas., Ben Love; Asst. Treas., Rose Ellen Calkins.

The first business meeting was held October 14, 1995. Members agreed to pay \$30 apiece for expenses and \$70 for initial investment. Thus the club started with \$1,750 for investments. Stock evaluations were originally done by manually filling out data forms. Computer analysis of stocks rapidly replaced the manual process, and today the club uses on-screen visualization to compare nominated stocks for purchase.

The current VIP membership is 19, and the total club valuation has risen to over \$170,000.



Karate Club

In June 2000 Shotokan Karate began with five students. Training was on Wednesday mornings. In 2002 the SCV Karate Club became a chartered club. Since those in training spent so much time together, spouses became social (non-training) members, and frequent family dinners out kept everyone acquainted. By December 2003 there were 13 students in training and 23 total members. In January 2004 the first SCV black belts were awarded and training was on both Wednesdays and Fridays. At that time, there were 22 members and 11 actively training. When the Dance Studio was finished, regular classes were changed to Mondays and Wednesdays, with an advance ShitoRyu class on Fridays. Since 2001, SCVKC has awarded twelve orange, nine blue, six brown, and four black belt promotions. Currently, traditional Shotkan/ShitoRyu classes are on Wednesdays; self defense classes are on Mondays.

Lighten Up

We are Sun City Vistoso's own weight-loss support group. We do not advocate any particular diet, sell food, have a connection with any national group or have a fee. We meet most Fridays for 40 minutes from October to May and report if we have gained, lost, or stayed the same since our previous weigh-in. We offer encouragement and ideas on how to keep weight off. Residents trying to maintain a certain weight are also welcome.



Mexican Train Dominoes

The Mexican Train Dominoes Club was initiated in spring 2000. Peggy and Tom Biehler noticed that there was little scheduled for residents on Saturday evenings. They canvassed their friends, found the necessary people to be assigned a room, and gave the game a try. Initially the residents contributed 25¢ per person to help cover the cost of refreshments. When the club received its charter, the dues were \$2.50 per person.

Officers: Pres., and VP, Peggy and Tom Biehler; Treas., Fran Prutzanni; Membership Chair, Julie Balogh. Julie and Fran also took on the responsibility of the refreshment committee.

If you listen carefully you can hear the sounds of the train engine, the clicking of dominoes and the lively chatter of the club members coming from the Catalina Vista activity center every second and fourth Saturday at 6 PM.

Mah Jongg



Six Mah Jongg Club Presidents

L-R: Sonny Kaye, Ruth Damlich, Joyce Unger, Evelyn Richards, Carol Rosner and Merle Briefer.

Started in 1994 by a few women, the Mah Jongg Club now has over 50 members who meet for three hours on Thursday afternoon at Desert Oasis.

The club first met at Desert Oasis, then moved to Catalina Vista for several years and then back to Desert Oasis after the card room was established there. Players rotate partners throughout the afternoon so all have a chance to play with each member.

Mah Jongg is a Chinese tile game, similar to Gin Rummy. In China it is primarily a man's game as it is in worldwide Oriental communities. In America mostly women enjoy the game.

The club offers lessons for new and brush-up players. We have a luncheon twice a year at interesting Tucson locations followed by an afternoon of Maj play. Once or twice a year we lunch at Desert Oasis preceding play.

Modelers Club

The Modelers Club was organized to enable modelers of all categories to meet and exchange ideas. The club was started in 1992 by Bill Melcher and was chartered in June of 1993. The meetings consisted of informal discussions, guest speakers, occasional tours of interesting local sites and Show-and-Tell of members' projects. At present the members' interests consist of model airplanes, model railroads, model boats and plastic models of all sorts. The club purchased and maintains a display case in the Social Hall for exhibiting projects of the members.

Parkinsons Support

In the year 2000 a group of residents gathered to explore the possibility of forming a support group for those who have Parkinsons. In time the support group did materialize and has functioned well for approximately seven years. The meetings consist primarily of persons with PD (Parkinsons Disease), their spouses or partners. Meetings are also open to anyone interested in learning about PD.

The purpose of the group is to address challenges of living with PD. These challenges are met through two objectives: (1) education provided by invited speakers and professional resource specialists and (2) mutual support within the group.

Photo Club

The Sun City Vistoso Photo club was founded in 1992 by Ken Amsler and Bill Ratsch. Bill was the first president. In the beginning it was generally a club of "point and shooters." Members brought their small photos and we showed slides. Slowly, rules were established and, with competition, the quality of the prints and slides improved.

In 1997 Catalina Vista was built with a fully equipped darkroom for the club, allowing for black-and-white developing and printing. Since then, Catalina Vista has been the club's regular meeting place. We have dedicated wall space in the hall to display our best work.

In 2001, due to declining interest in darkroom work, to better use the space and with the advent of digital imaging, we decided to turn the darkroom into a studio. Now it is used for board meetings, classes, workshops and as a digital darkroom, complete with three computers, a printer, a dry mounting press and a setup for still life and studio lighting.

The digital revolution is in full swing with slides being replaced by digital image projection. The images keep getting better and better.

Pilates

Pilates Club became a chartered club one year ago, though we have been practicing for the past four years. Initially, Sun City Vistoso sponsored a Pilates class at the Social Hall. That first summer we had a steady group of three to five participants. As the news about the healthy benefits of increased flexibility and strength grew, we grew as well. Current participation in our twice weekly classes is 20+ during the winter when our snowbirds are here. Last fall we decided there was enough interest in Pilates to form a chartered club.

Racquetball



L-R: Harry Edmonds, Nancy Healy, Liana Broadstone, Phyllis Carvollo.

The side-by-side racquetball and handball/squash courts were in use prior to the organization of the Vistoso Racquetball Club in January 1992. Officers were: Pres., Dan Kilbride; VP, Tony Blake; Sec./Treas., Liana Broadstone. Harry Edmonds volunteered free instruction to encourage more women to play. C.C. Dye suggested a

ladder ranking to match players of similar ability. Annual membership dues were set at \$2 and remain that today.

Over the years members have participated in Senior Olympic competitions as well as club matches. Picnics are held in addition to the annual membership dinner meetings. Various days and times for play were tried. Some of the charter members continue to play.

The handball court has gone through several evolutions until it has become the weight room in the Fitness Center.



RV Club--Sundowners

Adventure is the name of our game! Fun and fellowship are our goals!

In 1993, several recreation enthusiasts gathered together under the leadership of Darryl Handy for the purpose of finding parking and storage for their RV. Soon the idea of forming a travel club was spawned with the initial roster showing 82 names.

Early Presidents Larry Rastofer and Tom Spratt, plus their board members, not only encouraged group trips but also monthly meetings that emphasized RV education and camaraderie.

In 1995, 35 rigs set out for Organ Pipe National Monument. Subsequent trips included such scenic spots as Copper Canyon, Mexico; the Pasadena Rose Parade; the Albuquerque Balloon Festival and several national parks.

The name "Sundowners" is rooted in Australian folklore. Sheep shearers, referred to as "Sundowners," set a goal to arrive at their next destination before the sun went down. And so it goes with RVers.

Happy Trails!

St. Philip's Support Group

The St. Philip's Support Group was started in 1992 by a few members of St. Philip's in the Hills Episcopal Church to fill an observed need of giving attention and support to residents who were lonely, sick or had just experienced a death in the family. Beyond that we have funded special music, furnished a music room in the church and collected food for the less fortunate in the Tucson area. We meet quarterly to talk, exchange news and share food. The Support Group is open to any resident.

Scrabble



Over 14 years ago, a small group of new arrivals to Sun City Vistoso formed the Scrabble Club. The love of combining words (yes, even the strange but acceptable two-letter words) was the glue that brought us together. The beginning of the group was not without struggles as we hashed and rehashed rules that would work for all. We agreed the *Official Scrabble Player's Dictionary* would be our spellcheck guru.

Seniors for Kids



Seniors for Kids was formed in 1994 by Grant Bergemann. Grant's wife, Mary, was inspired by an article in *Parade Magazine* that featured a gentleman who made wooden toys for children in the hospital where his wife was being treated for cancer. Mary said, "Grant, this is something you could do." Grant shared this idea and Seniors for Kids was born.

About two months later, Marlene Ditty formed a group of women to sew cloth toys. The men and women joined forces and Seniors for Kids continues to bloom.

Seniors for Kids distributes wooden toys and games, fabric dolls, cuddly animals, receiving blankets, hats, booties, baby bibs and quilts to local hospitals every month. At Christmas, approximately 1,000 hand-crafted toys go to numerous charitable organizations.

For the past nine years Seniors for Kids has restructured outdated computers. In 2007 more than 100 computers were delivered to children in the community.



Sewing--Thimblelenas

The Sun City Vistoso Sewing Club, known as the Thimblelenas, consists of four groups, Casa Amigas/Project Linus, Ladies Seniors for Kids, Quilters and Trauma Teddies, organized under a single charter. These groups are open to all members. The Sewing Room is open to all members for personal and group sewing.

Casa Amigas and Project Linus

This is a group of ladies who sew clothing, quilts, and other items for the children of the Tucson, Oro Valley, and Catalina areas. The main recipients of the items made are Casa De Los Niños, Amphi School District clothing bank, and Catalina Resource Center. A chapter of Project Linus works within Casa Amigas and provides quilts and afghans for the children in local hospitals. The group uses clean donated fabric and yarn and receives monetary donations from many groups to help them purchase what they need to continue their work.

Trauma Teddies



Trauma Teddies began in February 1991 as the idea of Kay Zagarac Martin, Sun City Vistoso Activity Director. Kay asked resident Chris Remington to head the project. Chris designed a small soft washable toy to be given to any child in crisis.

Del Webb originally funded all the supplies. In recent years, all needed materials have been provided by generous donations of Sun City Vistoso organizations, residents and members of the group.

Most of the teddies are delivered to the Children's Cancer Ward at University Medical Center. Special Christmas teddies are created for the Children's Party at the Catalina Food Bank. As of December 2007, 3,417 Trauma Teddies have been donated.

Silversmith and Lapidary

In 1988 several residents of Sun City Vistoso found that they had a similar interest in silversmithing and lapidary work. They went to the Administration, requested and received the use of two rooms in the Craft Complex. They were also given lapidary equipment from Sun City West in the Phoenix area which is still used today. The original name of the club was Las Plateros which was later changed to Silversmith and Lapidary. One of the founders, Keith Staley, is still active in the club.

Each year classes in silversmithing are given. We estimate that several hundred people have been trained since 1988. The display windows of our shop have a constant display of our work in both silver and lapidary.

Sun City Vistoso Singers



Sun City Vistoso Singers all dressed up for their Christmas 2005 program.

Sweet Music for 19 Years

Our community was just two when the 31 members of the Sun City Vistosos, the forerunner of the Sun City Singers, sang for their first event. Over the years, they have added more events and special concerts. In addition to the annual concert in December, the Singers now present a spring show, a Fourth of July celebration, and provide the chorus for the annual *Messiah* sing-along.

Money earned from concert ticket sales pays for new music and copyright fees. The Sun City Singers have provided funds for the piano, for lighting and sound equipment, and other auditorium improvements.

The Singers have had only four directors: Richard Sprowl, Charles Osterberg, Barnetta Anderson, and, since 1995, Dorisse Coats.

Sun City Vistoso Singles

The Singles Club came into being 19 years ago, not with a bang but a whimper. We were a small group of about fifteen women and one brave man, sometimes swelling to 20 people. We had meetings once a month with some form of entertainment like a film, book review, game night, miniature golf and a barbecue, but many times we played bingo which was considered gambling without a license. The winners had to be paid outside the Social Hall so we wouldn't be raided.

Once a month we left Sun City Vistoso for greener pastures. Among our activities were a moonlight ride in Sabino Canyon, a day at the races, performances by Sons of the Pioneers, pizza dinner and the Flandreau Planetarium. The largest attendance we ever had was 37 people for a free dinner. The Singles Club has come a long way since then; we even have men now! Current membership is 195.

Softball--Vistoso Boomers

In the early nineties, Del Webb had a softball team. It was started by Charlie Pugiafico, Bill Sarmir and Al Mullenkoph. Now that our community is getting younger, this would be a great activity for the "baby boomers". We advertised in the Tipster, had tryouts and lo and behold the Vistoso Boomers were born. The team currently is managed by Steve Arnold, and the current record is 18 and 12.

Spanish Cultural Club

Club de Espanol began in 1992 with Rob Robison, Pres.; John Shaw, VP; Helen Jakubauskas, Sec. and Glee Nagahashi, Treas. The club has sponsored Spanish language classes from the beginning, but recently changed its name to emphasize an interest in the history and culture of the Southwest, Mexico, Latin America, and Spain. "It is good to be bi-lingual but even better to be bi-cultural." Joe Pomeroy taught Spanish classes from the beginning and for many years.

Monthly meetings have featured speakers from the university, docents from the Tucson Museum of Art, Border Patrol agents, travel shows by members and group trips to the Tucson Pastorela in December. One long-time member, Jose Hernandez-Rivera, has entertained the club on a number of occasions with music from his native Puerto Rico. Most attendees of club meetings speak little Spanish but find the club enhances their appreciation of Spanish culture.

State Clubs

We come from all over the world! Below is a count by location taken from the community directory. Many residents from the same state have organized and meet as a group. Historically the 50 fir trees planted along Rancho Vistoso Blvd. were decorated by the various groups representing the 50 states during the holidays.

Alabama.....5	Kentucky.....8	North Carolina...9	Wisconsin.....148
Alaska.....16	Louisiana.....2	North Dakota....5	Wyoming.....9
Arizona.....98	Maine.....7	Ohio.....76	
Arkansas.....8	Maryland.....16	Oklahoma.....7	<u>Other:</u>
California.....341	Massachusetts.35	Oregon.....50	Canada.....15
Colorado.....114	Michigan.....131	Pennsylvania...55	District Of Columbia.....4
Connecticut.....25	Minnesota.....188	Rhode Island....8	England.....6
Delaware.....4	Mississippi.....2	South Carolina...2	France.....2
Florida.....24	Missouri.....34	South Dakota....8	Germany.....3
Georgia.....6	Montana.....16	Tennessee.....2	Ireland.....2
Hawaii.....12	Nebraska.....16	Texas.....36	Puerto Rico.....1
Idaho.....10	Nevada.....13	Utah.....6	Scotland.....1
Illinois.....273	New Hampshire.8	Vermont.....3	Sweden.....1
Indiana.....38	New Jersey.....80	Virginia.....28	Switzerland.....2
Iowa.....38	New Mexico.....16	Washington.....25	
Kansas.....29	New York.....120	West Virginia....8	

Swedish Embroidery

The Swedish Embroidery Guild was started by Frances Staley on March 14, 1990. Membership at that time was limited to 30, since it was difficult to find the Huck fabric that is used for the embroidery. For several years there was a waiting list of people who wanted to join our club.

Every Christmas we had a party at Frances' home and during the year she planned excursions for us. We would go to lunch and then to a local attraction, such as Phila- baum's Glass Studio and the stores in the Barrio.

We were invited to attend a meeting of the Needlework- ers Guild here in Tucson where we displayed some of our projects and gave a brief history of Swedish embroidery. Frances was a great teacher and a good friend. Our club continues to welcome new members who want to learn the art of Swedish embroidery.

Senior Olympic Swim Team



'90 Swimmers: L-R: Jeff McClain, Nancie Healey, Evie Sprowl, Mink and Bill Beckel, Ginny Kirkwood, Birdie Schultz.

Swimming down memory lane is replete with great athletes/competitors, close to 100 back in 1990-91 and about 700 other athletes at the time including Del Webb's President of Development of Sun City Tucson, Dennis Wilkins. With Del Webb's backing there were cheerleaders, jackets and sweat suits. We were a huge force in Tucson, state and national competition thanks to the coach, Bill Bechel.

Early swimmers in 1991-92 were Ginny Kirkwood, Bill Bechel, Nancy Healy, Evie Sprowl, George Karp, Mary Jane Budreck, Bonnie Lamm, Harry Dobiesz, Dave Malkin, Bernie Fox, Lou Domin, Irene Camp, Ella Taylor and Tom Shaffer.

Many have since joined the ranks of the Senior Swimming Olympians. It's been a fantastic 20 years.

Table Tennis



Table Tennis started in early 1991 with 25 hearty souls playing outside at the Sports Complex Pool. In April 1991, the "Satellite Recreation Committee" assigned us to Desert Oasis. We played there until 1996 when we moved to Catalina Vista. This meant we would no longer trip on carpet, crash into walls, or go through another plate glass window.

Over the years, the club has visited and played tournaments in other communities as well as hosting play here. These tournaments, as well as some great natural ability of our members, allowed many to win medals in local, regional, state, national and international Senior Olympics.

Table Tennis is known as the fastest table game. While that may be true, we have all levels of experience with both men's and ladies groups on the calendar.

Tapestry Rug Hooking



In 1992 Robert Taylor came to the Tucson area looking for hookers. (No, not that Robert Taylor... and not that type of hooker.) Bob learned the craft of rug hooking after his retirement in North Carolina and brought it with him when he moved to Sun City Vistoso. In the remaining 10 years of his life he taught his craft to nearly 150 new rug hookers.

Within the last ten years, hooked rugs created by John Shaw have received national recognition appearing in the magazine Rug Hooking and as juried entries published in A Celebration of Hand Hooked Rugs.

Some of the results inspired by Bob Taylor's teaching can be seen on the walls of our library and in the window of the Ceramics Room. Bob would be pleased that we are carrying on his tradition of creating art from simple strips

of wool cloth.



Tennis

In 1987 a few Trailblazers met on the Sun City Vistoso tennis courts. Claire Foreman Casurella remembers when Receptionist Norma Meyers would notify her of new tennis players. She would contact that person, and thanks to her and the others' dedication in promoting tennis, a club was born.

From 1987 to 1992 the club functioned with Edith Fleury as the first president. Under her leadership the format for the present club evolved. In November 1993 an official application, with Doug Trask and Tony Gioia as signers, was presented to the SCVCA board. The new charter was ratified in January 1993. By February the group had grown to 121 with Doug Trask the newly elected president.

During our existence we have grown both in numbers and interest in contributing to the community in which we live. We sponsor fundraisers/tournaments to support philanthropic organizations such as Brewster Center, Casa Amigas, and Seniors for Kids. In addition, we are proud that, with additional financial help from the Association, we were able to add numerous amenities to the tennis court environment.

Now, in 2008, the tennis club has 182 members. We are pleased to be a vital part of such an active adult community.

Travelogue

Starting as a sidebar under the Travel Club by Bill Seipel in the mid-1990s, the project was folded into the Dinner 'N Show Club at its advent. Jim Huffer presided over this transition and continues to show a travelogue or documentary monthly on the third Monday.

Recent showings have included Rick Steves and Samantha Brown presentations. Also, our host, Jim Huffer has shown some of his personal travelogues.

Weight Watchers

The Sun City Vistoso Weight Watchers celebrated its fifth anniversary in October 2007. The group continues to expand as well as retain a core group of committed seniors who have achieved their goal weight and maintained it or are currently working toward that end.

In total, our group has lost more than 4,000 pounds in five years and helped more than 50 men and women get to their goal weight and become lifetime members.

This group of retired men and women is proof that you're never too old to go after your goals. Members support each other, week after week, to learn to live healthier lives and put smiles on the faces of our primary care doctors. We are truly a family of caring members.

Woodcarvers and Gourd Art



One evening in 1989 a group of men in the newly formed Square Dance Club were discussing hobbies when the subject of woodcarving arose. One of the members was artist and woodcarver Dick Ward who agreed to teach carving classes if the others could come up with 20 members to start a chartered club.

The group initially met in the Tumbleweed but found it too small and soon moved to the Lapidary where

the Woodcarving Club continues to meet.

Through various fundraising activities, power carving machines, woodburning sets and hand tools were purchased by the original membership. Most of these tools are still in use today nearly 20 years later!

In 2003 a newly formed Gourd Art group was added to the Woodcarving Club membership. Together we hope to continue the artistic traditions of the founders.



Woodworkers

The Woodworkers Club has been in existence since the beginning of Sun City Vistoso. Over 610 residents have taken advantage of the facilities and services provided by those who have made the club a viable organization. When the shop was first opened, Del Webb hired residents to be monitors. Those paid monitors supervised the operation of the shop. As the membership grew and the Association became more involved, the monitors became unpaid volunteers. Many of the Woodworkers are members of Seniors for Kids. Thousands of toys have been produced in the shop. The Woodworkers have also assisted other clubs and organizations with special woodworking projects. As early as 1988, the club made requests to increase the size of the shop. Thanks to the efforts of the club and the Association, the recently completed expansion project added 75% more space to the shop.

Writers Club

Our Writers Club began informal meetings in 1990 and was officially chartered in 1992. Early members included: Maggie Rinehart, Drucie Otterson, Jane McKinney, Toni Lutter, Charlie Osterberg, Larry Ackland, Pat Nebe, Ann Wright, Peggy Comp, Carol Small, Bonnie Lamm, Ebb Dozier, Arlene Lehto and Eloise Pomeroy.

Associated groups were Novelistas, who met in members' homes for critique and Writers of the Purple Page which published two books of prose and poetry and still remain active. Today, the Poets Corner holds weekly self-instructive workshops and is currently compiling its first collection for publication.

Over the years, the club has provided professional instructors, beginning with Sandra Schaulis and Ethel Paquin; invited guest speakers such as Doris Woods, editor of the former *Catalina Sunrise* which published our poems and short stories, hosted public readings and sponsored competitions for prose, short stories and poetry.



Yoga

In the beginning a resident taught a small yoga group. By 1992, a professional teacher offered her expertise. Eventually, a loosely formed club evolved. By 1998, the requirement for a club was 20 members. In order to accomplish this, our Yoga Club joined the Tai Chi Club. Officers were shared. Once yoga membership exceeded 20, it separated from Tai Chi. We have had a total of seven certified instructors now directing three weekly classes for men and women. The increased participation reflects our superior, certified professionals, two of whom are registered nurses. They have often complimented the yogis and yoginis on their progress, even though several participants have physical problems and challenges. Sun City Vistoso yoga predated the surge in popularity.



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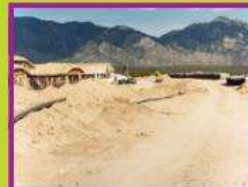
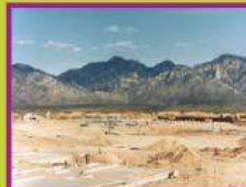
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Rancho Vistoso Blvd.



Mountain Vista



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DECEMBER 1, 1968; eight Sales Counselors arrived at the Northwest Corporate Center; to begin sales for Sun City Tucson. We worked out of this building until the model complex was completed. Our selling tools were two large vans that could carry 15 people to the community to preview, & pick their home site. The models were not fully completed, but enough to show to buyers. Rancho Vistoso Blvd was just a dirt road no bridge. This was truly an experience coming over the hill & seeing nothing but desert with a few graded roads, & unfinished models. People were absolutely amazed. We would return to the sales office & they would say, "Where we sign?" These are pioneers or now we call them "TRAILBLAZERS". I am so proud of this community & all the hard work that went into it. Some of the original staff is still here, Norma Meyers, Max Cruz, Mary Kay Cunningham, Patrick Boulton & Betty J. White.

We sold 100 homes in the month of December 1986.



Chalk Creek Dr.



Sports Complex Pool



**Outside the
Navajo Room**



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